

Block**3****MEDIA PLANNING FOR DEVELOPMENT**

UNIT 10**Planning a Development Communication Campaign**

UNIT 11**Development Communication Campaigns: Case Studies**

UNIT 12**Implementation of Development Communication Project**

UNIT 13**Corporate Social Responsibility for Development**



UNIT 10 PLANNING A DEVELOPMENT COMMUNICATION CAMPAIGN

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10.0 INTRODUCTION

Development is a significant phenomenon to measure and define the condition of a society or nation. As discussed in the previous Units, each society must identify its development priorities, goals and should devise strategies to meet these goals. Communication has been used as a tool of persuasion since the 1960s in most developing countries. And with the communication revolution, it has been recognized as one of the essential tools of survival.

Development communication is a systematic use of communication to reach the development goals of the nation. It is a planned process directed towards the development of various sectors in both urban and rural areas. So, when a journalistic approach gets involved in strategizing communication for development it is termed development journalism. As you have already studied in the previous units, journalists like Juan Mercado and Alan Chalkley were instrumental in development journalism. No development is possible in any area, whether scientific, agricultural or political, without proper communication. Thus,

in this Unit, we shall learn how the different proponents of development communication use a proper strategy to plan a campaign to achieve the desired outcomes. The origin of development communication can be attributed to the west mainly through new technology-oriented research projects of government, universities and research institutes. Thus, we will learn how to use unidimensional and multidimensional communication channels in an organized manner for development communication.

10.1 LEARNING OUTCOMES

After studying this Unit, you should be able to:

- define development communication and discuss the relationship of development and communication;
- outline the concepts of development communication;
- discuss the various paradigms and approaches to development communication;
- analyze the strategies involved in development communication campaigns; and
- plan a development communication campaign.

10.2 CONCEPTS OF DEVELOPMENT COMMUNICATION

Similar to communication, the connotation of development has been construed differently by various scholars. While the widely understood meaning is that it helps improve society's living conditions, scholars have digressed views on what exactly living conditions constitute and how they can be accomplished (Melkote & Leslie, 2015). According to Sinha (2013), most proponents believe that communication tactics in a planned manner constitute development communication.

10.2.1 Goals of Development Communication

The terms development and communication came together in the 1940s in the U.S. The primary aim of the formation of this new discipline was the **2E'S - Emancipation and Empowerment**. Though these two terms gained broader circulation and usage in the discipline, social and material advancement became more widely used and became its cornerstone. It is evident that without emancipation and empowerment, the mission of development communication has minimum effect and effectiveness.

Therefore, the engagement of stakeholders becomes a vital aspect if development has to be brought about in a sustained manner. According to Everett Rogers (2008), development communication can prove instrumental in making a conducive environment for bringing about social and behavioural change through effective distribution of information and assessment of threats and opportunities. You will thus agree that the functions of development communication encompass not just dispensing of information but engaging with stakeholders and assessing the situation. According to Manyozo (2012), the key proponents of development communication with different approaches include Daniel Lerner (1958), Everett Rogers (1962), and Wilbur Schramm (1964).

The characteristics of development communication include people-centric processes, fulfilment of basic needs of people, use of local knowledge coupled with contemporary science, and self-sufficiency, both in terms of processes and locally available resources (Narula, 1994). This is possible only if there are transformations at the fundamental, social and behavioural levels to combat the inequities within the society. In other words, the capacity to embrace social change via technology, culture and politics is key to development success.

In the same league, it is essential to understand the definition and goal of communication campaigns. Communication campaigns are an organized communication activity, focused on a particular population for a defined duration to achieve a specific goal. The term campaign includes planned, communication-based interventions directed at large groups of people and social marketing efforts that include communication activities. Campaigns have been specifically used to endorse diverse health behaviours, including medication use, changes in dietary habits, following traffic rules and seat belt use, prevention of substance, family planning, disease screening etc.

10.2.2 Major paradigms of Development Communication

As discussed above, the concept of Development Communication has evolved due to changing socio-economic and political ideologies. Development Communication can be viewed through three major ideological prisms a. the dominant paradigm (modernisation), b. the opposing paradigm (dependency), and c. the emerging paradigm (participation).

10.2.2.1 Modernisation as Development

It must be noted that during the initial development of the discipline of development communication, the 2E'S of Emancipation and Empowerment were to be achieved through the process of modernisation. This was a complex transition process from traditional societies to modern societies strictly by moving on the path laid by the western states.

This thought process dominated the mainstream culture, and capitalism and modernity were touted as the answer to development issues. According to this approach, development was equated with economic growth, which could be achieved by following capitalist-driven western economies. According to Daniel Lerner (1958), the mission of development communication was the transformation of traditional societies following the development dictate of the U.S. In other words, "What America is, the third world countries aimed to become".

Supporters of this approach espoused that this model is generally applicable in different contexts and that adopting contemporary know-how will benefit everyone. Paulo Freire (2008) further delineated four levels at the cultural, technocratic, political and economic levels. Thus Modernisation became the mantra to change the mind-set of individuals in developed countries (Lerner 1958).

However, the approach was criticized by critics who felt that it centered on the monetary aspect and disregarded the socio-cultural impact. According to Servaes (1991), the approach lacked cultural responsiveness, was theoretically flawed, and had methodological gaps.

Communication was linked with disseminating information and messages aimed at modernizing the under-developed countries and their people. The communication model provided by the media was a vertical or one-way model: Sender-Message-Channel-Receiver (SMCR) as advocated by Lasswell (1948). This model, which hinged on the persuasive power of the media, was believed in till the 1970s (Freire, 2008), in which communication was instrumental in modernizing the peoples' outlook, which would favour the economic model (Melkote and Stevens 2001). However, the disappointment with modernisation forced a rethinking of the paradigm. It became evident that media singularly cannot alter the people's mindset and that audiences are not passive receivers of information (Freire, 2008). This led to the emergence of new perspectives in development communication between 1970 and 1980.

10.2.2. 2 Dependency as Development

Disagreeing with the modernisation paradigm for being very Western-centric and ignoring any unconventional pathway to development, the dependency theorists emphasized that communication has to be linked with culture. Development and underdevelopment cannot exist in isolation, and a combination of historical, financial and political aspects impacts it (Frank, 1969).

This outlook was developed basis a structural analysis of the international capitalist system (Freire, 2008), with the underlining philosophy that political and economic reformation is critical to enable equitable distribution in society (Freire, 2008; Melkote& Leslie, 2015). The dependency approach sought to address the disparities in the world's state of affairs and proposed a binary strategy for developing countries. At the first level – nationally, the countries need to be economically self-dependent. At the second level - Internationally, there is a need to forge a sturdy political association (Freire, 2008). The stance demanded an equitable exchange of information, communication and cultural associations amongst deprived and privileged countries. However, the approach was unsuccessful in delivering a suitable method/s to address development challenges. Critics accused that this approach focused primarily on economics while ignoring the social and cultural factors just like the dominant paradigm. In addition, media and the flow of information did not play a significant role, and there was a continuation of one-way communication. However, the key difference between the two theories lay in who held the control for sending the message and for what purpose. Accordingly, supporters of this perspective asked to re-examine the communication line to internationally enable an unbiased stream of communication. They suggested that the various communication elements within countries should be revisited, and more thrust should be given to private and community media (Freire, 2008). This perspective gained momentum during the 1970s but gradually lost bearing around the 1980s.

10.2.2.3 Participation as Development

As the name suggests, the model is more concerned with people's participation than economic and political factors. You may all agree that "Participation" is considered a key component of sustainable development strategies since it is embedded in the cultural realities of that particular community or society. This perspective, which focuses on people's empowerment, is also referred to as liberation or monastic approach since it practices development and social change (Melkote, 2015). According to Melkote (2015), Paolo Freire's (1973) contribution

to liberation theology has been most distinguished. Other approaches that emerged on participatory and people-based development include the multiplicity paradigm (Servaes, 1991) and the empowerment approach (Friedman, 1992). These theories have shared features such as indigenous ideas of development, are people-centric, and emphasize how can bring empowerment and rights awareness at grassroots (Freire, 2008). The key feature of the Participatory paradigm was the focus on common communication values and practices. As a result, development communication has emerged as a ``two-way’’ model that emphasises stakeholders’ engagement and dialogue. The traditional media is often used for initiating this engagement. This model also evaluates risks, identifies solutions, and seeks consent for action. The ability of this approach to shift the focus from mere distribution of information to an exploration of the circumstances and persuasion to participation is considered a key to the success of sustainable development efforts. Thus the scope of communication gets broadened from merely informing people to initiating change.

10.2.3 Approaches to Development Communication

Development communication can be approached through different perspectives, many of which complement each other. The main approaches can be condensed under the following headings:

- 1) **Diffusion of Innovation approach:** As the name suggests, this perspective emphasizes innovations by individuals and communities. These innovations could be social or technological and could usher in new ideas, services and products. In this, diffusion of both material and social innovations is essential for development. The decision to accept or reject an innovation depends on the need of the individual or community choice.
- 2) **Mass Media approach:** This focuses on the availability of a well-developed mass media and interpersonal communication infrastructure. People should be able to access this infrastructure both socially and physically, and the content should be balanced and need-based, having a combination of rural and urban-oriented messages.
- 3) **Development support communication approach:** In this approach, objective communication goes beyond informing and educating to motivating people and acquiring their participation in the growth and processes of change. People must be aware of the development plans for them to co-operate in national development. Development support communication is different from development communication as it addresses the planning and operational aspects for putting into practice.
- 4) **Institutional approach:** The mainstay of this approach is education for development. It emphasizes literacy and need-based training and development.
- 5) **Cohesive approach:** This approach centres on maintaining a balance of information for rural and urban areas and avoiding duplication and waste of development efforts.
- 6) **Community based approach:** This is a localized approach that focuses on Community-based communication systems. It is participatory, and local communities can be encouraged to plan and produce communication material relevant to attain the desired objectives.

- 7) **Strategic approach:** Development communication will be successful if communication agencies (extension workers, radio, TV, Press, etc.) work in coordination with and development agencies to achieve the desired outcomes.

Check Your Progress Exercise 1

Notes: 1) Use the space below for your answer.

2) Compare your answers with those given at the end of this Unit.

- 1) Explain the concept of development communication.

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- 2) What are the main paradigms of development communication?

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- 3) List the critical approaches to development communication.

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10.3 APPROACHES TO DEVELOPMENT COMMUNICATION CAMPAIGN

As discussed above, campaign planning for Development Communication can have a multi-pronged approach. These approaches have to be kept in mind while planning development communication campaigns. Proper strategy must be used for creating communication campaigns for development. Among the various methods are the Adoption Ladder, the Integrated Model, Communication for Development, Rights-based approach, micro and macro-level approach. Let's briefly discuss these methods:

10.3.1 The Adoption Ladder

One can understand people's fundamental adoption of messages by understanding them as part of a ladder in ascending order. Awareness, Interest, Attitude, Legitimization and Practice constitute the steps of the ladder.

- 1) Awareness- People must be aware of the problem
- 2) Interest- After being aware, they need to be interested in solving the problem.
- 3) Attitude- Attitude for accepting and adopting any change must be present
- 4) Legitimization- We need to make sure that the innovation is in lieu of all the laws and the norms of the community
- 5) Practice- Before adopting, people need to practice the innovation to test its effectiveness.

10.3.2 Integrated Model

This model emphasizes community dialogue and collective action to work together to bring about social change. This includes externally generated changes, individual behaviour, social influence, and community dialogue and collective action.

- i) **Externally generated change**-Change can be generated through external agencies and then integrated by the community. An example is the construction of mobile clinics that can reduce diseases within the community and construct potable water systems that can end water problems within the local communities.
- ii) **Individual behaviour change**-Behaviour change can be brought about at the individual level through community dialogue and messaging from the media. This is illustrated by adopting washing hands, drinking clean water, making children drink polio drops.
- iii) **Social influence**- People who have adopted change influence others or motivate or persuade others to do the same. For example, The community leaders who have sent their children to school will influence and motivate others to do the same.
- iv) **Community dialogue and collective action**- Members of a group come together to find a problem solution—an example of these community members coming together to construct a Public Toilet to end open defecation.

10.3.3 Communication for Development (C4D)

The approach to communication for development evolved after World War II and enabled one-way transmission of information to a two-way flow of communication. While one-way transmission included grand media campaigns and information dissemination, two-way communication includes interpersonal communication. This came together with the emphasis on participatory approaches to development and the development countries voices at the global level. This was done with the belief that interpersonal communication is effective in transforming knowledge to continued practice. The approach is people-centric and focuses on the needs and aspirations of people and their different realities.

10.3.4 Rights-based Approach

Another approach for developing a communication development campaign is a rights-based approach wherein individuals and groups are made aware of their rights to question the stakeholders and duty bearers. However, collaboration and support are required from the private sector, civil society and state to enable the

marginalized to enjoy their basic rights. This implies that Non-Governmental Organisations (NGOs) have to shift their approach from supporting the delivery of services to building the capacity of civil society to be a structured and effective balance to the power of governments and the private sector.

This approach has been utilized to secure land rights for the poor, prevent conflict, develop capacities to claim rights, etc. Steps to design a development communication campaign keeping in mind the rights-based approach include -

- 1) **Causality Analysis-** This involves the identification of the problem and its causes.
- 2) **Pattern Analysis-** The next step is to identify the duty bearer or stakeholder concerning that particular problem.
- 3) **Capacity gap analyses-** In this step, one needs to understand the gap and why that right has not been realized. It could be that the claim holder cannot claim the right or the duty bearer cannot fulfil its duties.
- 4) **Identification of candidate actions-** These actions reduce the gap between duty bearers and claim bearers.
- 5) **Programme design-** The actions should be divided into specified projects, and clear objectives should be defined.

A well-known case study of the rights-based approach in India is that of RACHNA {Reproductive and child health, nutrition and AIDS}. Implemented by CARE in India, this programme is one of the most extensive public health campaigns across the World, which directly influenced women and child health of more than 100 million in India.

Based on the existing public health programs, the programme catalyzed and mobilized communities to concentrate on a set of preventive interventions of recognized value to achieve committed, measurable outcomes of considerable scale. These included reducing children's malnutrition and mortality, up turn the use of reliable, modern contraception, and reducing the risk of HIV transmission in high-risk groups. The program was regularly reviewed and supported Field Level Workers (FLWs) through the capacity building during review meetings and supportive supervision.

10.3.4 Micro-Level Approach

In this approach, the development communication practitioners realized the importance of the mix and match approach of the media channels/platforms. The baseline is that the communication channel should be a mix of the traditional and the new media, and interpersonal communication should also not be underestimated. The following steps should be taken in designing the channel selection.

- 1) **Most used media:** One needs to identify which is the most used media by the target group of a particular community. The locals must be accustomed to this media.
- 2) **Platform selection:** We need to understand that different media platforms have different roles; hence, selection must be made keeping the various dimensions of the target audience in mind like gender, occupation, rural/urban, etc.

- 3) **Recall value:** We should choose a media platform with maximum recall value in the target audience and provide maximum motivation.

Traditional media in India is a treasure. It has been a part of the people's lives and integrated into the social structure for ages. People relate to this media and require no special training to get accustomed to it. Their belief system to this internal stimulus is intact. One of the most essential attributes of traditional media is that it provides immediate feedback.

Therefore, we can say that in development communication, the process of effective behavior change can be easily reached by combining mass media with alternate media as and when necessary.

10.3.5 Macro-Micro Level Approach

This approach involves the use of Media advocacy by using a combination of media and interpersonal communication to bring about the desired change and social acceptance of a concerning issue. The desired output media advocacy uses the print media, electronic media, and online media appropriately, along with keeping the decision-makers in the loop.

This approach allows more excellent traction of the advocates with the policymakers. Media advocacy is thus a complex process involving overall change, strategy, well thought out plan. One needs to keep the following stages in mind while creating a Media advocacy toolkit -

- a) **Framing-** Framing an issue ensures that you communicate the essential items of the message so that when the message gets placed in appropriate media, all essential elements get the limelight. Steps of framing include a) converting individual problems into social issues, b) tracing the problem to its root cause and avoiding blame game) presenting solutions rather than talking about the problem) making practical policy appeals by suggesting simple solutions) developing pictures and images to make people relate to the problem) tailoring the solutions according to the needs of the audience.
- b) **Developing a communication plan-** This is a blueprint or a step-by-step plan of what needs to be done at which stage. This includes a) crafting one's public image- policymakers need to understand what can be the impact of their steps) articulating key messages-these are like tag lines linked to the problem) identifying target audience- we need to understand our target audience, their requirement, aspirations, understanding and which channel or media do they relate to) developing strategies and tactics- we need to answer all the questions relating to what, when, how, and how who.
- c) **Creating local media attention-** It is essential to get appropriate media attention to spread awareness and desired change.
- d) **Follow through-** We need to keep evaluating the entire Campaign at every stage and keep bringing about the necessary changes.

Check Your Progress Exercise 2

Notes: 1) Use the space below for your answer.

2) Compare your answers with those given at the end of this Unit.

1) What are the critical features of Communication for Development?

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2) What are the various steps for using the micro-macro approach in development communication campaigns?

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10.4 PLANNING A DEVELOPMENT COMMUNICATION CAMPAIGN

A development communication campaign planning may require different strategies, models, approaches depending upon the location, target audience, desired behavioural changes, available media, etc. So here, we will give an insight into the strategies, approaches, and models involved in creating a development communication campaign.

10.4.1 Formative Research

Formative research is research conducted during the planning stages of a campaign to better the Campaign. It has multiple uses as it can help segment the audience in homogenous groups, select the campaign's focus, decide the content and tenor of the messages, choose appropriate channels and pretest messages and programs (Mody, 2003). Examples of the successful implementation of this approach are in the development of educational media such as Children's Television Workshop's Sesame Street (Palmer, 1981); a project in Nicaragua run to teach children Mathematics over the radio (Friend, Searle & Suppes, 1980) and educational programmes beamed over satellite in India, aimed at the rural population. The Satellite Instructional Television Experiment (SITE), launched in 1975, involved the broadcast of educational and instructional content including health, hygiene, family planning, nutrition, improved practices in agriculture and events of national importance. Through formative research is an accepted practice, it is not always done when the campaign planners already know their audience or have already produced their material.

10.4.2 Social Marketing

This strategy is based on the Diffusion of Innovation approach proposed by Philip Kotler and Gerald Zaltman (1971). They were the key researchers in establishing that social marketing strategies could be used for solving developmental concerns related to health and other social problems. This was the most popular model from 1960 to the 1980s. One standard definition of social marketing as given by Gerald Zaltman pertains to the “design, implementation and control of programmes” designed to stimulate the acceptability of social ideas. It thus entails deliberation of “product planning, pricing, communication, distribution and marketing research”. Development communicators use the contemporary approach of using ideas received from marketing specialists rather than using ideas of the sociological perspective. In other words, they believe in using commercial marketing tools and techniques to promote pro-social behaviour. With the primary focus being behaviour change, this method gave heightened importance to persuasion. The process of bringing about change in behaviour through knowledge generation was following social marketing practices and was individual-oriented. Individuals formed the base for the social marketing practitioners, and it was through them they addressed groups and organisations to try and bring about a particular desired behaviour.

In practice, social marketing activities include setting specific, measurable goals for the Campaign and targeting specific sections of the audience with communications designed for them (Mody, 2013). The campaign planner also needs to conduct formative research with the target audience to ensure that the target behaviour or product is acceptable and appropriate to the audience. It also involves pretesting of messages, monitoring the implementation of the Campaign and evaluating it.

Many social marketing projects were launched and implemented in the 1980s and 1990s on diarrheal diseases, family planning, immunisations, and environmental concerns using the mass media.

Mac Fayden, Lynn Martine Stead and Gerard Hastings (1999) talked about several elements of social marketing.

- 1) **Consumer Orientation-** In social marketing, the consumer is considered most important. A rapport is developed with the consumer, and his/her inputs are collaborated in all stages from formative to the evaluative stage of the entire Campaign.
- 2) **Exchange-** In marketing, the basic principle is exchange. Exchange does not occur unless there are two or more parties, each with something to exchange with each other. When we apply social marketing in development communication campaigns, the examples of exchange can be condoms in exchange for the generation of a sense of security about contraception.
- 3) **Long Term Planning-** Like generic planning, even social marketing requires long term planning in the development communication process. It starts and ends with research and keeps altering the Campaign and divides it into stages, incorporating the necessary changes when required.
- 4) **Moving beyond individual consumer-** Social marketing strategies in development communication begin with individuals, but their basic focus is on groups and organisations and bringing about behavioral changes at the macro level.

Thus, we can see that being like commercial marketing in nature, and social marketing aims at designing developmental campaigns to promote socially beneficial practices or products with significant themes like AIDS, unwanted pregnancies, literacy etc.

10.4.2 Advocacy

Advocacy is used in some campaigns to influence policies, rules, regulations, or Laws rather than direct behaviour change. The main targets for advocacy campaigns are policymakers or officials with corporations and government, although some try to influence public opinion. Examples of health advocacy campaigns include national and workplace breastfeeding policies, national immunisation policies, women's rights and birth control policies (Mody, 2013). Advocacy campaigns have been widely used in the environment. This approach depends on the organisation of the community, civil disobedience, lobbying and public relations. In practice, this would entail organizing events and tours to educate policymakers and the media, circulating petitions, letter writing and boycott initiatives. One such example in the Indian context is how a campaign to stop constructing a dam saw the organisation of rallies, marches and hunger strikes (Pick, 1993). Another example is a campaign targeted at government officials organized to preserve Brazil's indigenous land management rights.

10.4.3 Entertainment Education

This strategy shares the same idea of behaviour change as of social marketing strategy. EE'S strategy is to disseminate messages through mass media. It works on the ideology of using entertainment media such as cartoons or soap operas to transmit information that can result in behaviour change. EE refers to designing a particular message which educates while entertaining and create specific changes in behaviour. EE has three basic premises.

- a) **Influence:** This approach believes that exposure to entertainment media and its messages influences people to dress, talk, eat in a particular fashion. However, this influence can be both positive and negative. Therefore, the effort is to use media to disseminate positive messages for constructive behavioural changes.
- b) **Education:** This approach emphasizes that one can educate while entertaining and that education need not be boring all the time. Everett Rogers is one of the principal architects of EE.

Example of EE strategy in planning a development communication campaign in India is an educational entertainment radio soap opera designed for the Hindi belt, and 52 episodes were broadcast in four Indian states of Bihar, Jharkhand, Madhya Pradesh and Chhattisgarh for a year in 2002-2003. It targeted rural men and women of reproductive age, and its messages were centered on reproductive health, family planning, AIDS, literacy, female feticide, etc. The broadcast captured a wide section of listeners with people displaying greater awareness about family planning, the importance of girl child, literacy etc. The Campaign drew on the theory of diffusion of innovation and SMCRE Model.

Entertainment Education's stress on behaviour change borrows from Albert Bandura's social learning theory of two I's - Imitation and Influence. The BBC

Media Action, for instance, used creative mass media initiatives in 2007 and 2009 to help reduce levels of HIV infection by making condoms more acceptable to Indian men. The Campaign, which includes public service advertising, included a know-it-all parrot, a kabaddi king, a condom ringtone and a puppy named Condom. The goal was to get men talking about condoms, a challenge in a country where sex is largely considered a taboo subject. The communication strategy included a light-hearted approach to communicate a serious message and propagated practical approach to safe sex. The Campaign's mascot was a colored parrot, a bird generally associated with speech and intelligence. The tagline was "JO BOLA WOHI SIKANDER (Those who talk are winners) " on World AIDS Day. At the onset of the Campaign, nearly 400,000 people responded to a riddle whose answer was condom and 25 randomly selected winners received mobile phones with free talk time.

The riddle campaign reached 54.2 million men aged 15-49 across four states in just three weeks.

Check Your Progress Exercise 3

Notes: 1) Use the space below for your answer.

2) Compare your answers with those given at the end of this Unit.

- 1) Explain the various strategies for creating a development communication campaign.

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- 2) What are the advantages of using the Education Entertainment strategy for development communication campaigns?

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- 3) Social marketing remains a crucial strategy for communicating socially beneficial practices or products. Comment.

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10.5 LET US SUM UP

Let's conclude by recapitulating the entire planning of the development communication campaign in brief. So, a communication plan or Campaign is designing a strategy of two-way communication

- 1) Define your objectives
 - a) What you want to say
 - b) To whom you want to say
 - c) The need to do the same
 - d) What geographical areas have you chosen for your message
- 2) Choose your target audience- keeping in mind different approaches choose your target audience starting from individuals moving on to groups, keep all their characteristics needs demands in mind
- 3) Create your message- keeping in mind your target audience your objectives. The locality creates your message in a way that can have maximum acceptance and motivation
- 4) Choose your channel- medium of communication depending upon its reach penetration and adaptability, be innovative incorporate two or more channels
- 5) Have a two-way communication channel
- 6) Plan a budget
- 7) Implement your plan
- 8) Keep reviewing and taking feedback
- 9) Incorporate the changes required
- 10) Evaluate your progress

Thus, this is how we can plan a development communication strategy using various approaches while keeping in mind the requirements of a particular group at a particular time and area.

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10.6 ANSWER TO CHECK YOUR PROGRESS EXERCISE

Check Your Progress Exercise 1

- 1) Development has been construed differently by various scholars. While the widely understood meaning is that it helps improve society's living conditions, scholars have digressed views on what exactly living conditions constitute and how they can be accomplished (Melkote & Leslie, 2015). According to Sinha (2013), most proponents believe that communication tactics in a planned manner constitute development communication.

The primary aim of the formation of this new discipline was the 2E'S - Emancipation and Empowerment. It is important to note that emancipation and empowerment should remain focused on effective development communication besides social and material advancement. Therefore, the engagement of stakeholders becomes a vital aspect if development has to be brought about in a sustained manner. According to Everett Rogers (2008), development communication can prove instrumental in making a conducive environment for bringing about social and behavioural change through effective distribution of information and assessment of threats and opportunities. The characteristics of development communication include people-centric processes, fulfillment of basic needs of people, use of local knowledge coupled with contemporary science, and self-sufficiency, both in terms of processes and locally available resources (Narula, 1994).

In the same league, it is essential to understand the definition and goal of communication campaigns. Communication campaigns are organized communication activities focused on a particular population for a defined duration to achieve a specific goal. The term campaign includes planned, communication-based interventions directed at large groups of people and

social marketing efforts that include communication activities. Refer to Unit 10.2 for more details.

- 2) The concept of Development Communication has evolved as a result of changing socio-economic and political ideologies. Development Communication can be viewed through three major ideological prisms a. the dominant paradigm (modernisation), b. the opposing paradigm (dependency), and c. the emerging paradigm (participation).

The development paradigm equated it with economic evolution, which could be realized by following the pattern of the capitalist-driven western economies. Thus Modernisation became the mantra to change the mindset of individuals in developed countries who were encouraged to leave behind their traditional beliefs and imbibe novel practices. Further, communication was linked with disseminating information and messages to modernize the under-developed countries and their people.

The dependency paradigm examined the connection between communication and culture. According to this, development and underdevelopment are parallel processes and cannot exist in isolation. The dependency approach sought to address the disparities in the world's state of affairs and proposed a binary strategy for developing countries. The approach necessitated an equitable exchange of culture and communication, creating a balance between the privileged and the underprivileged countries. The participatory model focused on the empowerment of people through two-way communication. This implies active participation and interaction with people with the help of traditional media. For more details, please refer to Unit 10.2.2.

- 3) The critical approaches to development communication are the Adoption Ladder, the Integrated Model, Communication for Development; Rights-based approach, micro and macro-level approach.

The Adoption Ladder approach emphasizes on a step-wise process for adoption of any innovation. In contrast, the Integrated Model emphasizes community dialogue and collective action to bring about social change. Communication for Development focuses on two-way communication, including interpersonal communication. The approach is people-centric and focuses on the needs and aspirations of people and their different realities. The Rights-based approach is about making individuals and groups aware of their rights and building the capacities of communities to defend their rights. In the Micro-level approach, importance is given to mix and match the media channels. The baseline is that the communication channel should be a mix of the traditional and the new media, and the incorporation of interpersonal communication should also not be underestimated. Therefore, we can say that in development communication, the process of effective behaviour change can be easily reached by combining mass media with alternate media as and when necessary. Alternatively, the Macro-Micro approach utilizes media advocacy to bring about the desired change and acceptance. For more details, please refer to 10.2.3.

Check Your Progress Exercise 2

- 1) Communication for Development is participatory. The approach is people-centric and focuses on the needs and aspirations of people and their different realities. This uses a combination of traditional media's one-way communication and interpersonal communication, taking into account the needs of the communities. For more details, please refer to 12.3.3.
- 2) The Micro-Macro approach involves the use of Media advocacy by using a combination of media and interpersonal communication to bring about the desired change and social acceptance of a concerned issue. The steps involved include
 - 1) Framing- Framing an issue ensures that you communicate the essential items of the message so that when the message gets placed in appropriate media, all essential elements get the limelight.
 - 2) Developing a communication plan- This is a blueprint or a step-by-step plan of what needs to be done at which stage.
 - 3) Creating local media attention- It is essential to get appropriate media attention to spread awareness and desired change.
 - 4) Follow through- We need to keep evaluating the entire Campaign at every stage and keep bringing about the necessary changes.

Check Your Progress Exercise 3

- 1) The planning of a development communication campaign may require different strategies, models, approaches depending upon the location, target audience, desired behavioural changes, available media etc. The key strategies used

Formative Research-Formative research is research conducted during the planning stages of a campaign to better the Campaign. It has multiple uses as it can help segment the audience into homogenous groups, select the campaign's focus, decide the content and tenor of the messages, choose appropriate channels and pretest messages and programs.

Social Marketing- This is the design, implementation, and control of programmes calculated to influence social ideas' acceptability and involve consideration of product planning, pricing, communication, distribution, and marketing research. This approach uses commercial marketing tools and techniques to promote pro-social behaviour. The primary focus is on behaviour change, with importance given to persuasion. In practice, social marketing activities include setting specific, measurable goals for the Campaign and targeting specific sections of the audience with communications designed for them.

Advocacy- Advocacy is used in some campaigns to influence policies, rules, regulations, or Laws rather than direct behaviour change. The main targets for advocacy campaigns are policymakers or officials with corporations and government, although some try to influence public opinion.

Entertainment Education - It works on using entertainment media such as cartoons or soap operas to transmit information that can result in behaviour

change. EE refers to designing a particular message which educates while entertaining and create specific changes in behaviour.

- 2) The Education Entertainment strategy uses entertainment media such as cartoons or soap operas to transmit information that can result in behaviour change. It brings together the advantage of having the advantage EE refers to designing a particular message that educates while entertaining and creating specific behaviour changes. It influences behaviour change and adds an element of entertainment to education. There are several examples where this strategy has been used effectively. For instance, BBC Media Action used creative mass media initiatives in 2007 and 2009 to help reduce levels of HIV infection by making condoms more acceptable to Indian men. The Campaign, which includes public service advertising, included a know-it-all parrot, a kabaddi king, a condom ringtone and a puppy named Condom. The goal was to get men talking about condoms, a challenge in a country where sex is largely considered a taboo subject.
- 3) **Social marketing remains a crucial strategy for communicating socially beneficial practices or products. Comment.**

Social Marketing involves creating and implementing programmes that impact the adoption of novel social notions among the target audience. There is considerable planning, pricing, distribution and marketing research involved. This approach uses commercial marketing tools and techniques to promote pro-social behaviour. The primary focus is on behaviour change, with importance given to persuasion. In practice, social marketing activities include setting specific, measurable goals for the Campaign and targeting specific sections of the audience with communications designed for them. It has been used in many social marketing projects during the 1980s and 1990s on diarrheal diseases, family planning, immunisations, and environmental concerns using the mass media. It involves consumer orientation, exchange, long term planning and moving beyond individual consumers. Since it is akin to commercial marketing, it is often used to promote socially beneficial practices or products with significant themes like AIDS, unwanted pregnancies, literacy etc.

UNIT 11 DEVELOPMENT COMMUNICATION

CAMPAIGNS: CASE STUDIES

Structure

- 11.0 Introduction
- 11.1 Learning Outcomes
- 11.2 Development Communication Campaign-Definition
 - 11.2.1 Core Concepts: Communicators and Receivers
 - 11.2.2 Campaign: Purpose, Goals and Meaningful Change
 - 11.2.3 Broad Types of Campaigns
 - 11.2.4 Steps to design a campaign
- 11.3 Case Study I: *Majboor Kisko Bola* - Preventing Bonded Labour in India
 - 11.3.1 Social Change and Equality
 - 11.3.2 Empowering the Marginalized
- 11.4 Case Study II: Swachh Bharat Mission (SBM)
 - 11.4.1 Concerted Efforts for Cleanliness
 - 11.4.2 Success Mantras: Aspects of a Successful Campaign
- 11.5 Case Study III: Beti Bachao Beti Padhao (BBBP)
 - 11.5.1 Focus on Girl Child
 - 11.5.2 Using Social Media and Interaction
- 11.6 Let Us Sum Up
- 11.7 References and Further Readings
- 11.8 Answer to Check Your Progress Exercise

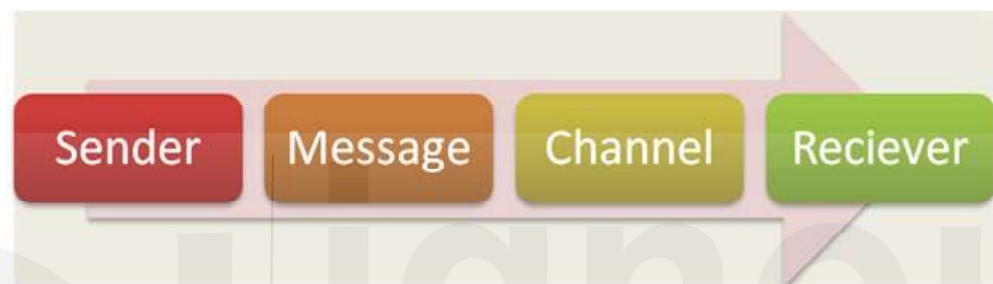
11.0 INTRODUCTION

Development Communication can be defined as employing methods of communication to induce social change effectively. The intent and purpose of the efforts are aimed at development. Development Communication is rooted in the belief that change can be created, and it involves the participation of key stakeholders. The ideal outcome is a sustainable and long-term change, which can be effected through various means. Development communication is a multi-faceted application of communication, which can affect behaviour change and perceptions of society towards specific concerns like health, community welfare, equality etc.

The need and purpose of using communication to achieve development goals are connected to a post-WWII world. With time, the need to harness the potential of mass media for the benefit of all was discussed at the highest of forums. The International Commission for the Study of Communications Problems, known as the MacBride Commission in 1977 and the subsequent report *Many Voices, One World* presented at the Belgrade Assembly in 1980, resulted in the launching of the International Programme for the Development of Communication (IPDC). The Programme objective states the need to strengthen “*the means of mass communication in developing countries, by increasing technical and human resources for the media, by developing community media and modernizing news agencies and broadcasting organisations.*”

Development communication is a broad field or category in communication: it includes series of practices, specific methods and media. The process from start to finish is multi-dimensional and tiered. Development projects and programs are meticulously strategized and implemented, keeping in mind many attributes. A key aspect of development communication is the engagement of stakeholders in assessing key issues helps to mitigate risks and prevent the emergence of problems and conflicts before they arise. The contemporary approach also creates a horizontal base of thinking rather than a top-down approach, which can also involve suggestions from the target group or the beneficiaries.

The most basic model of development communication was based on the Sender Message-Channel-Receiver (SMCR) model. Over time and with evolving target groups, audiences coupled with exposure to media, the efficacy of this model has been challenged.



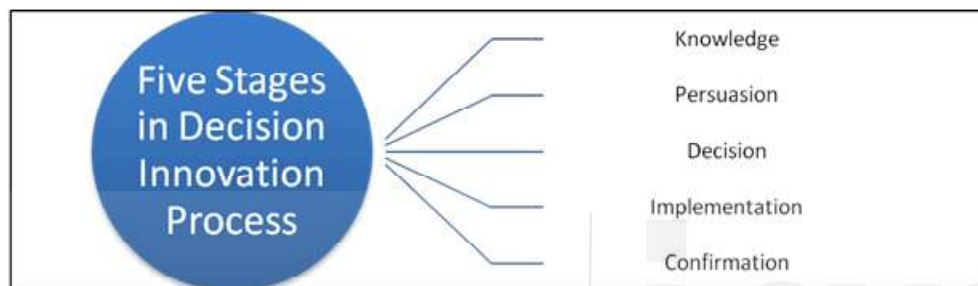
Pictorial Representation 1: Traditional SMCR model

The way this model envisions a linear way of sender transmitting a message through the appropriate channel to a receiver (or group of receivers) is considered inadequate for a long-lasting social change. The dissemination of information in the SMCR model cannot be comprehensive because it can achieve the intended behaviour change. It has been proven by case studies and research groups that change of human behaviour is a complex mechanism. To persuade change requires the “receivers” active role by constantly including their feedback in the communication model. Also, the linear flow and top-down approaches of any communication via a message are rendered ineffective if it is not participatory and seek feedback.

Daniel Lerner (1958), Everett Rogers (1962), and Wilbur Schramm (1964) are considered critical scholars who have contributed to the concepts of development communication. Their views and suggested models associated with Development Communication are critical to the current understanding and evolution of media and development: Daniel Lerner and Wilbur Schramm supported the dominant paradigm. The dominant paradigm equates development to economic growth and proposes the use of technology for development and change. Development is constantly juxtaposed with modernisation, and the role of communication is considered important for technological development. According to this perspective, modernisation, as understood by the western world, is an important aspect contributing to overall development. For Daniel Lerner, indicators of development are:

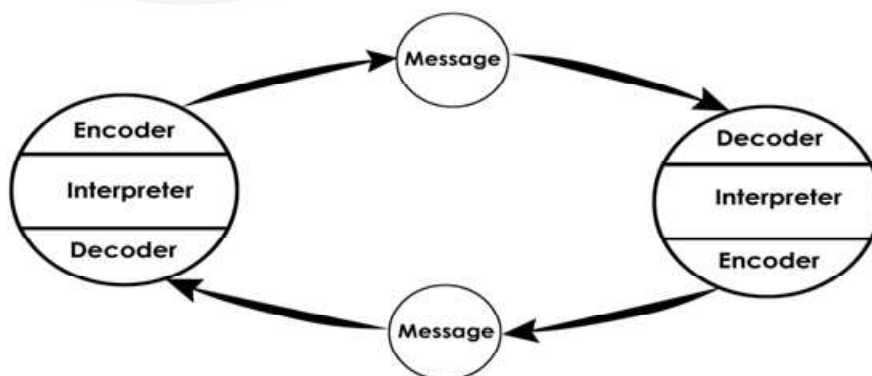
- Industrialisation
- Literacy
- Media Exposure and
- Political Participation

According to Everett Rogers, the effectiveness of development communication to support social change will require the participation of key stakeholders. Rogers is considered a pioneer in introducing the diffusion of innovations theory. He emphasized diffusion as “the process in which an innovation is communicated through certain channels over time among the members of a social system”. Diffusion of both material and social innovations is necessary for development—economic and technological innovations and social needs and structure form material and social innovations. The diffusion process starts with the need for individual and community decisions to accept or reject the innovation. In this reference, he proposed the concept of the early adopter, which later has emerged as positive deviance. Rogers’s theory has been proven effective in the areas of health and nutrition.



Pictorial representation of Stages in Decision Innovation Process

Willber Schramm (1954) emphasized encoding as an essential part of the communication process. The relationship between the information provider and the recipient is the core of his theory. The encoding process by the sender and decoding by the recipient is also related to the recipient being able to understand or decode the information that the sender wants to communicate. Otherwise, the message is actually of no use. Thus encoding and decoding between sender and receiver, unlike the SCMR linear model, are the two most important factors of effective communication without which information can never flow between two individuals. Schramm’s model also revolves around the above principle. According to Schramm’s model, coding and decoding are the two essential processes of effective communication.



Pictorial representation of Osgood-Schramm Model of Communication

These models are critical to understanding the complex nature of human communication and the complexity of designing communication for development purposes. Development Communication campaigns are specifically designed around the problem, characteristics and are tailored to incite behavioural change. The nature of the problem/issues, and the purpose of the effected change require different campaign strategies.

11.1 LEARNING OUTCOMES

After studying this Unit, you would be able to :

- Know the purpose of Development communication;
- explain the role of a Development communication Campaign;
- study the attributes of effective campaigns and the outcomes they generated;
- assess the diverse use of mass media platforms for social change;
- assimilate the overall development goals in the microcosm of specific communities; and
- identify the message for media platforms in specific case studies.

11.2 DEVELOPMENT COMMUNICATION CAMPAIGN- DEFINITION

A development communication campaign is an organized effort implemented within a specific target group to disseminate information, engage attention and interest in the message, and affect change. All campaigns have short term and long-term goals and are led by a team of policymakers, government officials, non-governmental players and preferable stakeholders from the community.

Any communication campaign is a well thought out strategy or communication activity focused on a specific audience, specific period and aimed at achieving a goal.

For example, The Pulse Polio Campaign in India to create awareness on inoculation, HIV awareness campaign in Uganda, Gender Equality Campaign in Mongolia etc.

11.2.1 Core Concepts: Communicators and Receivers

The philosophy of Development communication involves the participation of two major groups of people:

- 1) The communicators comprising development bureaucracy, nongovernmental organisations, media practitioners and professionals, and
- 2) The target audience: people with value systems and specific socio-cultural systems who can be educated or semi-literate or literate.

According to Everett Rogers, (1962), there are three significant paradigms of development identified ideologically and historically

- the dominant paradigm (modernisation),
- the opposing paradigm (dependency), and
- the emerging paradigm (participation).

All paradigms have generated different strategies in the overall history of development communication in the world. While the dominant paradigm bases its concept of development on modernisation and the adoption of technology, the opposing paradigm criticizes the western-centric approach of the dominant paradigm. The opposing paradigm emphasizes the relationship between

communication and culture. It also discusses the redistribution of resources between developed and developing countries. The opposing paradigm does not focus on communication as much as the other two paradigms.

The participation or emerging paradigm, which involves a considerable involvement of the target group, is considered to have more impact and positive change in the long run. This paradigm recognizes the diverse attributes of culture to bring about social change. It also supports the core values of sustainable development strategies.

11.2.2 Campaign: Purpose, Goals and Meaningful Change

Developing a communication campaign includes several stages: design, concept development, testing, production, and dissemination.

A development communication campaign differs from general communication in the following ways.

- Purpose: it is a value-laden communication intended for social change
- Goal-Oriented: The intent to instigate change for a positive outcome for the community, individuals in the long term, is paramount
- Holistic and Specific Change: To ensure the change in the social, political, economic, and cultural fabric of a society streamlines with the core values of that society.

11.2.3 Broad Types of Campaigns

There are two broad categories of communication activities used for social change (Snyder, 2003; Mody, 2003):

- 1) communication channel enhancement and
- 2) information provision.

Building capacities and the presence of media with the establishment of communication channels can accelerate development. An instance can be community radio stations in rural areas of India.

Communication Channel enhancement can be done by:

- 1) increased accessibility of communication technologies,
- 2) introduction to ICT skills, focusing on education knowledge about communication technology
- 3) organizing self-sustained networks of people who assist information flow and exposure to technology.

Although communication campaigns are only one type of activity, different activities are combined to create maximum impact.

The other is the provision of information and utilization of communication technology to create awareness and social change.

11.2.4 Steps to design a campaign

The broad steps to design a campaign aimed with a purpose of social change are:

1) **Information gathering and Needs assessment**

The aim of the communication will determine the information, which is critical to move further. This information can be gathered with the help of subject experts, analysis of community members, kind of media exposure already prevalent in the target group. It will also involve identifying experts and volunteers already engaged with the target group. This is a crucial stage for the Campaign to be successful.

2) **Developing a Strategy with Clear Objectives**

Each Campaign has a specific purpose and clear objectives. To achieve the same, there is a need to have a stepwise process put in action. This involves minute details like identifying critical and sensitive target group members who will stimulate maximum change. Conducting focus group studies at this stage further enhances the plan. The mix of communication tools and message attributes are decided at this stage. The scale and progression of the Campaign are also part of this stage.

- **Development communication Objectives design** is an essential part of the strategy. If the project's objectives are not adequately determined or there is an absence of a broad consensus among stakeholders, communication strategy will fail. If the basic foundations of development communication are neglected, the impact and results will lead to disappointment.

Identification of media vehicles based on objectives of the project and target group is part of this stage.

3) **Implementation and Collaboration**

This stage involves the actual action plan implemented on the ground. Creation and distribution of media material, employing trainers or ambassadors, capacity building of trainers etc., are essential aspects of the implementation stage. The Campaign is structured yet flexible enough to incorporate signals from the target group during the early implementation phase. This stage can also involve a smooth and effective involvement of concerned authorities and policymakers as the Campaign unfolds. Use of Media platforms, messages and packaging are essential attributes at this stage. Intermediality is also effectively used in contemporary times with the use of digital technology.

4) **Periodic and Final Evaluation**

The crucial aspect of evaluation is to check the campaign's progress at strategic points or identified milestones. Since the Campaign will find full maturity during its implementation with the target group, the need for realignment midway may arise. The periodic evolution allows flexibility and effectiveness. The final evaluation aims to identify and record the campaign's impact and the achievement of its objectives. The final evaluation report can also be used as a reference for future engagement with the target group.



Figure 11.1 Steps to design Campaign

Check Your Progress Exercise 1

Notes: 1) Use the space below for your answer.

2) Compare your answers with those given at the end of this Unit.

1) What is a Development Communication Campaign?

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2) What are the steps to design a development communication campaign?

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3) Give an example of a Development Communication Campaign, its goals and target audience.

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11.3 CASE STUDY I: *MAJBOOR KISKO BOLA* - PREVENTING BONDED LABOUR IN INDIA

- i) Title of Campaign : **Majboor Kisko Bola (MKB)**
(Who are you calling helpless!).
- ii) Implementing Agency : BBC Media Action

- iii) Objective : Preventing Bonded Labour in India
- iv) Geographical Area : Bihar and Uttar Pradesh.
- v) Target Group : People working as Labour in Bihar and UP



Figure 11.2

11.3.1 Social Change and Equality

Background

Bonded Labour is prevalent in many parts of India to date. Bonded labour was outlawed in 1976 with the Bonded Labour System (Abolition) Act. In 2013, the Criminal Law (Amendment) Act introduced 370 and 370A into the Indian Penal Code (IPC). This Act considers it a criminal offence to be involved in the process of trafficking someone — including recruiting, transporting and transfers, by any means. The States of Bihar, Uttar Pradesh, Chhattisgarh, Jharkhand and Madhya Pradesh are also hubs of labour in the cities and far-flung rural areas. This project aimed to help prevent bonded labour and inform workers about their rights in the states of Bihar and Uttar Pradesh. The project was funded by Google and inspired a new series focusing on three Indian states, Chhattisgarh, Jharkhand and Madhya Pradesh.

11.3.2 Empowering the Marginalized

Target group and Choice of Media

A baseline research conducted through the Information gathering in the areas. It was observed that some of the areas were media dark. The most viable and effective way of communicating to the masses was through the radio platform. A 52-episode radio programme aimed to increase awareness amongst vulnerable communities and in the mainstream society of what bonded labour is, what causes it, how it can be prevented and how people can have redress.



Source: <https://www.facebook.com/MajboorKiskoBola>

Unique Approach

Radio was chosen as the primary medium of disseminating awareness. The programs challenged prejudices of caste servitude and featured case studies. Innovative ideas like creating listener clubs were initiated. The centre of the village where people gather was used as space where people could listen to these programs. Working with local non-governmental organisations, the project maximized reach through listener clubs.

A Project Advisory Committee was also set up, consisting of crucial government members, local partners and media organisations, to highlight bonded labour issues in mainstream media and other public platforms. According to Ashish Yadav, BBC Project Manager, the main issue is about awareness. The team also



(Pictures of Press coverage and live events like Shrota Samvad)

Decades after independence, they still cry for freedom!



Labour officer of Mahasamund District replying to the complaints of labourer. A labourer narrating his ordeal in front of Government officials during the meeting. (Pics by Roshan Chachane.)

■ Staff Reporter
RAIPUR, June 27

BONDED labour is a big issue that is mostly left unaddressed as most of the bonded labourers of Chhattisgarh don't even know that they are bonded. Hundreds of such bonded labourers turned up to explain their ordeal at public meeting 'Shrota Samvad' organised by Samarthan, a Delhi-based Non-Government Organisation, in association with British Broadcasting (BBC) Media Action at small village of Tusda in Mahasamund District on Thursday.

Bonded labour, which was legally banned through Bonded Labour System Abolition Act 1976, is still thriving and prevalent all across the country. Labourers from states like Chhattisgarh, which is among the major states that are source of labourers, are suffering the most from this devious and evil system,

which was supposed to be disappear long time ago.

In a hot and humid day, hundreds of villagers, mostly victims of bonded labour came forward to register their complaint with Mahasamund Superintendent of Police, Sub-Divisional Officer and Labour Officer. The extent of their unawareness about the concept of bonded labour was astounding as most people don't even know what qualify as the work with consent and what is not. On top of that people don't even know the address of Labour Department's office, let alone concept of bonded labour.

Among many, Devlal Chakradhari, came to the stage and explained his ordeal with heavy voice. His young son, who had went to Uttar Pradesh for labour work was missing for last many days. Even the wages weren't paid by the employers, who exploited his son and many other labourers

of Chhattisgarh day and night.

A man named Ramadar went to Odisha to work in company namely JBM Polymers. After working for over 3 months, he was retrenched without any wage. Khamariya resident Devlal Ratte also narrated a similar story. He was taken to a place some 30 kilometers from Wardha of Maharashtra, where he and other labourers were treated worse than animals. There was no schedule for work whether day or night and when they demanded wages, employer thrown them out.

Samarthan also issued a number 9560213195, where the bonded labourers could give missed call if they need help. Samarthan, till date, has received around 1000 missed call from Mahasamund, alone. Now, one can guess the quantum of bonded labour in Chhattisgarh from the figures of Mahasamund. BBC Media Action is also running a radio programme 'Majboor Kisko Bola' that is being broadcasted in India through BBC radio services. The show encourages victims of bonded labourers to come forward and register their complaint with the officials and NGO.

Main issue is about awareness: Aashish Yadav

BBC Media Action Project Manager Aashish Yadav said that the main issue is about awareness. Most people, who opt to immigrate for work, don't get register with the Labour Department or even with the Panchayat. Main culprits in this matter are the middlemen, who lure the labourers to other states and leave them helpless. There is no control over the middlemen, who are very influential as all the efforts to curb them have been foiled at very high level.

mentioned that their most significant challenge was "reaching communities in India's most remote villages" in Uttar Pradesh and Bihar. BBC Media Action and local non-governmental partners established 40 listener groups of ten members each. Volunteers were given a radio player with the episode on a pen-drive in media dark sectors. The Members of these groups were the poorest and most vulnerable in a community, along with community gatekeepers, such as the village council and schools.

The project was a huge success in creating awareness within the target group on exploitation. Volunteers from the local community further disseminated their experiences and case studies informally to the local target group. The Campaign

got the attention of policymakers as well as local government bodies. Events to support the Campaign were aligned to multiply the reach of the message. Local Print Media was invited to be part of the Campaign to cover the case studies and the impact.

Highlights of the Campaign

- Intense ground research in the geographical area when the Campaign was planned
- Involvement of Local volunteers and local media
- Integration of media infrastructure as well as capacity building of a local volunteer
- Incorporation of Government and Non Government agencies
- Innovative thinking like *Shrota Samvad* to raise grievances of the marginalized group

Check Your Progress Exercise 2

Notes: 1) Use the space below for your answer.

2) Compare your answers with those given at the end of this Unit.

1) Explain the terms Bonded Labour and Marginalisation?

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2) What was the unique aspect of the Campaign?

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3) Give at least three highlights of the campaign MKB?

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11.4 CASE STUDY II: SWACHCH BHARAT MISSION (SBM)

i) Title of Campaign:	Swachch Bharat Mission (SBM)
ii) Implementing Agency:	Ministry of Drinking Water, Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs, Government of India
iii) Objective:	Solid waste management Sanitation and Safe drinking water
iv) Geographical Area:	India
v) Target Group:	Semi-Urban and Rural Communities
vi) Period:	2014- continuing

11.4.1 Concerted Effort for Cleanliness

The SBM is one of the most prominent developmental agendas of the Government of India in recent times. Swachh Bharat Mission (SBM), Swachh Bharat Abhiyan (SBA), or Clean India Mission is an India-wide campaign initiated by the Government in 2014.

The Census 2011 showed that in 4,041 statutory towns, close to eight million households do not have access to toilets and defecate in the open. Globally, India had a worse record than even poorer regions such as Sub-Saharan Africa, Haiti, Ghana, etc., in terms of open defecation in 2012, according to a June 2014 paper from the Research Institute for Compassionate Economics.

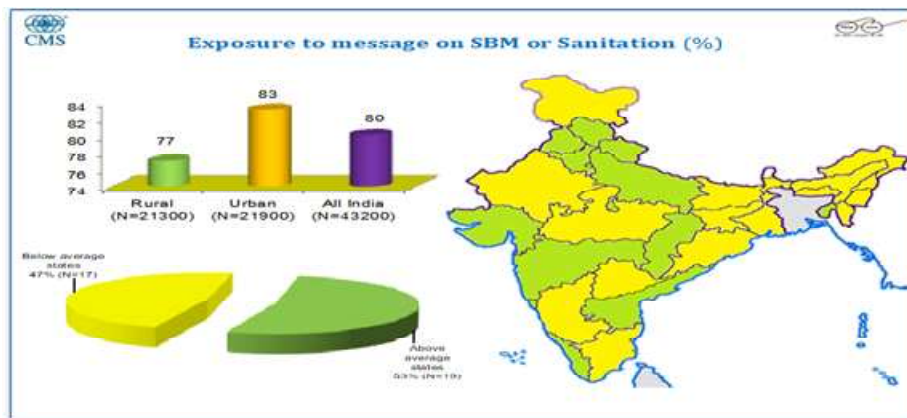
There is no denying the fact that SBM is a much-needed endeavour to improve sanitation standards in India. Weak sanitation has significant health costs, and untreated sewage from cities is the single most significant source of water resource pollution in India. This indicates both the scale of the challenge ahead of the Indian cities and the enormous costs of not addressing them.

Aimed at eliminating open defecation and improve the way we handle solid waste management. The mission was aimed at both sides of India -rural and urban. The ownership of both the sub-campaigns was with different Ministries. While in rural areas, “SBM - Gramin” was financed and monitored through the Ministry of Drinking Water and Sanitation; the “SBM - urban” was overseen by the Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs.

Apart from celebrities and public figures, the influencers were the volunteers, known as *Swachhagrahis*, or “Ambassadors of cleanliness”. They promoted indoor plumbing and community approaches to sanitation (CAS) at the village level. The Swachh Bharat Mission (SBM) has been effective in changing the mindset and behaviour of hundreds of millions of people concerning toilet access and usage. According to government data, 500 million people have stopped defecating in the open since 2014, down from 550 million to less than 50 million presently (according to GOI websites).

The funding to such a massive campaign was through the government as well as development agencies. The programme has received funds and technical support from the World Bank, corporations as part of corporate social responsibility

initiatives and state governments under the Sarva Shiksha Abhiyan and Rashtriya Madhyamik Shiksha Abhiyan schemes. The World Bank provided a US\$1.5 billion loan and \$25 million in technical assistance in 2016 for the Swachh Bharat Mission to support India's universal sanitation initiation.



Pic: A glimpse of need assessment survey done by CMS India on SBM

The Swachhta Status report released by NSSO, based on a survey conducted in May-June 2015, also showed that households belonging to states with poor access to water in toilets contribute more to open defecation. In Jharkhand, this percentage of 83.1% of rural households was the highest among all states. Odisha had the second-lowest share of rural households with access to water use in toilets at 84%. States such as Madhya Pradesh, Chhattisgarh and Bihar recorded similar outcomes. The numbers provide a much-needed context to evaluate the Modi government's budgetary allocations for SBM. In the 2016-17 Union budget, the government set aside Rs 9,000 crore for rural sanitation – the highest ever allocation.



Images of volunteers campaigning for SBM and innovative wall painted messages.



Announcement for SWACHHATA Selfie by AIR



Visually attractive and local painting on toilets.

Public Service Advertisements for SBM:

The government used an integrated approach to the communication of the message. All the major media - print, radio, and television advertisements focused on motivating the audience to change behaviour and start using toilets. Celebrities were also involved in the message.

For example, one of the advertisements targeting males questions the belief or cultural values of the males of household in trying to be very protective otherwise but letting the females go out in the open for defecating.



Images of shots from TV advertisements related to SBM

In another advertisement, the change of desired behaviour is intended by challenging the intellect of the target audience. The actress talks to a fly rather than directly to the target audience. This strategy stimulates the conscience of the audience.

11.4.2 Success Mantras: Aspects of a successful campaign

Any Dev Com Project generates results only if the many aspects of its creation, implementation and evaluation are supported by the overall power structures and support. Some of the aspects of a successful campaign are:

- **Political will**- intent and support of the topmost institution of governance at the same time will consist of the community to effect change. In the case of SBM, we witness this aspect – the *top (national/state governments) and grassroots level participated with Political will. (PRIs/ULBs)*

- **A strong Supply-side-** The support side to a Dev Com Project must be robust. This could include anything like infrastructure, logistics, technical know-how, financial resources, etc. In the case of SBM, this aspect has a mixed result. For example, people are sensitized in some areas, toilets have been built, but there is no running water
- **The motivation of the beneficiary** – The awareness about benefits, rights, entitlements can be essential for the success of a Dev Com project. In the case of SBM, this was **Average to High**
- **Involvement of multiple stakeholders.** For any issue being focused on as part of a campaign, there are multiple levels of stakeholders. In SBM, govt., non-govt., civil society, academia, media, religious leaders, children, youth, and women added to the success.
- **Multi-tiered and skillfully built Communication strategy** – which has attributes of sustainability, least resource-intensive and participatory. Projects which build the message seamlessly through multi-tiered media create maximum impact. In SBM, the intent was the same with the involvement of mass media, social media, traditional media, IPC, and action-based communication.
- **Constant Monitoring & Evaluation:** There are many ways to monitor a campaign's progress and evaluate the outcomes. In SBM, the usage of MIS, geo-tagging, concurrent research/assessments was an advantage to monitoring.

Overall we can see through the example of SBM that a Dev Com project is an evolving process, and in this particular case, there are some specific reasons which have enabled a positive impact. The project is still in continuation.

Check Your Progress Exercise 3

Notes: 1) Use the space below for your answer.

2) Compare your answers with those given at the end of this Unit.

1) Highlight the purpose of SBM and the associated government's ministries?

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2) Mention any two reasons for the success of SBM?

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- 3) Give an example of effective advertisement, which conveys the core of SBM?

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11.5 CASE STUDY III: BETI BACHAO BETI PADHAO

Introduction

- | | |
|--------------------------|---|
| i. Title of Campaign: | Beti Bachao, Beti Padhao (BBBP) |
| ii. Implementing Agency: | Ministry of Women and Child Development,
Ministry of Human Resource Development
Ministry of Health and Family Welfare |
| iii. Objective: | Save and Educate the Girl Child
Empowerment of Women |
| iv. Geographical Area: | India |
| v. Target Group: | Urban and Rural Communities |
| vi. Period: | 2014- continuing |

11.5.1 Focus on Girl Child

Beti Bachao, Beti Padhao, which means Save the Girl Educate the Girl, launched by Prime Minister Narendra Modi on International Day of the Girl Child in 2014. The Campaign is an effort to deal with a skewed child sex ratio of men and women, addressing the malice of female foeticide and its eradication and creating an inclusive society. The scheme was launched with initial funding of 100 crores. It mainly targets the clusters in Uttar Pradesh, Haryana, Punjab, Bihar, Uttarakhand and Delhi.

Background

India has been witnessing a skewed and declining Child Sex Ratio (CSR), i.e. number of girls per 1000 boys between 0-6 years of age, since 1961. The decline in 2011 from 945 in 1991 to 927 in 2001 and 918 in 2011 was alarming.

This decline clearly indicated women disempowerment and represented a growing trend of pre-birth discrimination caused by a conscious gender-biased sex selection and post-birth discrimination against girls. The societal norms and social conditioning in patriarchy cause discrimination against girls on the one hand. At the same time, on the other side – easy availability, affordability and misuse of diagnostic tools are the twin reasons for this grave ratio of fewer girls to boys at birth. The social conditioning in patriarchal societies constantly emphasises the need to have a son/boy to carry on the family lineage –thus compelling families across caste and class to desire a male child. The increasing Sex Selective Elimination of girls leading to a low Child Sex Ratio is a serious cause of worry for the future.

The Government of India understood the urgent requirement of coordinated and convergent efforts to stop the decreasing numbers of girl childbirth and survival. This meant a campaign with a strategy to ensure survival, protection and empowerment of the girl child. Government of India announced the Beti Bachao Beti Padhao initiative. This is a national campaign and focussed multi-sectorial action in 100 selected districts low in CSR, covering all States and UTs.

The Campaign is a joint initiative of Ministry of Women and Child Development, Ministry of Health and Family Welfare and Ministry of Human Resource Development.

The core objectives of this initiative are:

- Ø Prevention of gender-biased sex selective elimination
- Ø Ensuring survival & protection of the girl child
- Ø Ensuring education and participation of the girl child

BBBP also included targets like:

- Decrease dropout rate and increase enrolment of girls in secondary education
- Provision of functional toilets for girls in every school in selected districts.
- Assessing malnutrition and improvement of nutrition status of girls
- Protective environment for Girl Children through the Protection of Children from Sexual Offences (POCSO) Act 2012.
- Training and sensitization of Grassroot functionaries as Community Champions to mobilize communities to improve CSR and promote Girl's education.

It is also important to note that some of the tenets of SBM and BBBP are mutually interdependent, like providing water and sanitation facilities at schools. The absence of clean toilets has been identified as one of the many reasons adolescent girls leave formal education in rural India.



11.5.2 Using Social Media and Interaction

Since 2008, innovative telephony in India has changed the communication landscape of the country. In this social media and technology-driven age, combining the message with technology is a powerful method of bringing change and registering the content far and wide. To be effective, the strategy of using social media should be simple and appealing to target audiences. One example of using social media effectively is the *#Selfie with daughter* campaign launched by the topmost leaders of the country.



Sunil Jaglan, the sarpanch of Bibipur Village in Haryana's Jind district, initiated this Campaign in 2015, which received wide applause. Prime Minister Narendra Modi termed the *#Selfie with Daughter* as an international movement during his interaction with the Silicon Valley CEOs. Later, President Pranab Mukherjee launched 'Selfie with Daughter', a mobile application to raise awareness about female foeticide and sex selection. President Mukherjee himself asked people to take photographs with their daughters and upload them on the app to make the Campaign a success.

The campaign aims to motivate society to feel proud to be parents of a girl child, which will improve the child sex ratio.

The *# selfie with daughter* was one of the many ways in which BBBP was promoted.

Check Your Progress Exercise 4

Notes: 1) Use the space below for your answer.

2) Compare your answers with those given at the end of this Unit.

1) Highlight the purpose of BBBP and the associated government's ministries?

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2) Mention the importance of educating the girl child?

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3) Give an example of effective use of social media in relation to BBBP.

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11.6 LET US SUM UP

As displayed in the case studies, development communication is characterized by conceptual flexibility and diversity & suitability of communication techniques engaged in addressing and bringing responses to a problem. The main objectives of development communication are to create social change. It aims to contribute to a more equitable distribution of resources, human dignity, right to opportunity and many other issues concerned with socio-political, economic and cultural aspects.

Some of the outcomes of development communication campaigns are to:

- dissemination information and education,
- behaviour change,
- social marketing,
- social mobilization,
- media advocacy and policy intervention,
- communication for social change, and participatory development communication.

Mass Communication mediums are used as part of the strategy of planning a campaign. Combining old media with new media has been effective in educating specific populations in recent times. Information and communication technologies (ICT's) and multi-media can address visual and auditory aspects.

Developing a development communication campaign is an organized activity that involves extensive research and needs assessment. The resources are also aligned to the goals and purpose of the specific goal. Steps to design campaign are:

- Information gathering and Needs assessment
- Developing a Strategy and Objectives
- Implementation and Collaboration
- Periodic and Final Evaluation

Different campaigns with goals formed after information gathering require different approaches. The issues of development often are interrelated with the areas of health and health facilities, equality and opportunity for the socially marginalized, and inclusion. The case studies focus on these aspects in different parts of the world in different periods.

The Majboor Kisko Bola campaign highlights the importance of ingenuity of idea combined with the involvement of government representatives. It was successful in creating sensitization about rights and the ill effects of exploitation. It helped identify and represent the issues of the marginalized bonded and migrant labour in select Indian states.

The Swachh Bharat Mission (SBM) is one of India's most extensive developmental agendas. SBM, Swachh Bharat Abhiyan (SBA), or Clean India Mission, is an India-wide campaign initiated by the Government in 2014. The Census 2011 showed that in 4,041 statutory towns, close to eight million

households do not have access to toilets and defecate in the open. Weak sanitation has significant health costs, and untreated sewage from cities is the single most significant source of water resource pollution in India. This indicates both the scale of the challenge ahead of the Indian cities and the enormous costs incurred from not addressing them. Aimed at eliminating open defecation and improve the way we handle solid waste management. The mission was aimed at both sides of India -rural and urban. The ownership of both the sub-campaigns was with different Ministries. While in rural areas, “SBM - Gramin” was financed and monitored through the Ministry of Drinking Water and Sanitation; the “SBM - urban” was overseen by the Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs.

Beti Bachao Beti Padhao BBBP was launched to address the declining Child Sex Ratio (CSR) and other issues related to women’s empowerment, especially education. It intends to curb the declining sex ratio over the last few decades and strategize at empowering girl child and women; India has been witnessing a skewed and declining child sex ratio (CSR), i.e. number of girls per 1000 boys between 0-6 years of age since 1961. The Campaign also addresses the malice of female foeticide and its eradication. It mainly targets the clusters in Uttar Pradesh, Haryana, Punjab, Bihar, Uttarakhand and Delhi.

Activity 1

Interview with five people in your residential area to understand the term ‘development’. Identify five keywords from their answers, the implied meaning and list them down.

For example – ‘Development means facilities for all. Facilities can imply hospitals, health, clean water, sanitation, housing etc.

Sl. No	Key Word	Implied Meaning
1		
2		
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Activity 2

Visit a community Radio in your area. Write your experience in 300 words.

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Activity - 3

Read about the Pulse Polio Campaign in India. Highlight the salient features, use of media and reasons for its success

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Activity - 4

Write one tagline for the Radio program on Swachh Bharat Mission.

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Endnotes:

Development communication involves creating mechanisms to broaden public access to information on reforms, strengthening clients' ability to listen to their constituencies and negotiate with stakeholders; empowering grassroots organisations to achieve a more participatory process, and undertaking communication activities that are grounded in research. —World Bank, 2006

Acknowledgement for SBM

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Personal Interview:

Alok Srivastava, (Oct 3, 2020, Noida) Center for Media Studies, Director CMS Social.

11.8 ANSWERS TO CHECK YOUR PROGRESS EXERCISES

Check Your Progress Exercise 1

- 1) Development Communication can be defined as employing methods of communication to induce social change effectively. The intent and purpose of the efforts are aimed at development.
- 2) Information gathering and Needs assessment, Developing a Strategy with Clear Objectives, Implementation and Collaboration and Periodic and Final Evaluation
- 3) Examples are: The Pulse Polio Campaign in India to create awareness on inoculation, HIV awareness campaign in Uganda, Gender Equality Campaign in Mongolia etc

The pulse polio plan aimed to achieve 100% coverage in terms of the oral polio vaccine in India. The focus group was young children from 0-5 years, and the target audience was their guardians and parents.

Check Your Progress Exercise 2

- 1) **Bonded Labour:** Bonded labour in simple terms means work without wages and basic rights. It flourishes because of poverty and caste-based discrimination. It is equivalent to slavery, and humans are kept as a security against a loan or when they inherit a debt from a relative.

Marginalization: means a vulnerable position in a society or group. By nature of this position, the marginalized do not have access to basic human rights, dignity and facilities that the group enjoy.

- 2) The unique aspect of the Campaign was that radio was chosen as the primary medium of disseminating awareness. The programs were created with the involvement of local people and featured case studies they could relate to. Innovative ideas like creating listener clubs were initiated.
- 3)
 - 1) Involvement of Local volunteers and local media
 - 2) Incorporation of Government and Non-Government agencies
 - 3) Innovative thinking like Shrota Samvad to raise grievances of the marginalized group

Check Your Progress Exercise 3

- 1) The SBM is one of the most significant developmental agendas of the Government of India in recent times. Swachh Bharat Mission (SBM), Swachh Bharat Abhiyan (SBA), or Clean India Mission is an India-wide campaign initiated by the Government in 2014. SBM aims to eliminate

open defecation and improve the way we handle solid waste management. The mission was aimed at both sides of India -rural and urban. The ownership of both the sub-campaigns was with different Ministries. While in rural areas, “SBM - Gramin” was financed and monitored through the Ministry of Drinking Water and Sanitation; the “SBM - urban” was overseen by the Ministry of Housing and Urban Affairs

- 2) Political Will and Multi-tiered and skillfully built Communication strategy –attributes of sustainability, least resource-intensive and participation
- 3) Advertisement featuring Vidya Balan where she is discussing the issue of honour of the newlywed bride in connection to open defecation.

Check Your Progress Exercise 4

- 1) The core objectives of this initiative are:
 - Prevention of gender-biased sex selective elimination
 - Ensuring survival & protection of the girl child
 - Ensuring education and participation of the girl child

The Campaign is a joint initiative of Ministry of Women and Child Development, Ministry of Health and Family Welfare and Ministry of Human Resource Development.

- 2) India has been witnessing a skewed and declining child sex ratio (CSR), i.e. number of girls per 1000 boys between 0-6 years of age since 1961. The decline in 2011 from 945 in 1991 to 927 in 2001 and 918 in 2011 was very alarming.

BBBP is an effort to deal with a skewed child sex ratio of men and women, addressing the malice of female foeticide and its eradication and creating an inclusive society.
- 3) One example of using social media effectively is #Selfie with daughter campaign launched by the topmost leaders of the country. Sunil Jaglan, the sarpanch of Bibipur Village in Haryana’s Jind district, initiated this Campaign in 2015, which received wide applause and was supported by top leaders of the country.

UNIT 12 IMPLEMENTATION OF DEVELOPMENT COMMUNICATION PROJECT

Structure

- 12.0 Introduction
- 12.1 Learning Outcomes
- 12.2 What is Development Communication Project?
 - 12.2.1 Campaign – Meaning and Purpose
 - 12.2.2 Basic Steps – Constructing a Communication Strategy
 - 12.2.3 Characteristics of a well planned Development Communication Project/Campaign
- 12.3 Media Mix
 - 12.3.1 Meaning of Media mix
 - 12.3.2 Role of Community Radio
- 12.4 Social Media: Innovative and Participatory Dimensions
- 12.5 Let Us Sum Up
- 12.6 References and Further Readings
- 12.7 Answer to Check your Progress Exercises

12.0 INTRODUCTION

The expanse of development as a concept has a large panorama. The need for intervention and application of specific methods to instigate change for the larger good of society has constantly been a critical motivation of development communication specialists. Development Communication is considered a practical intervention to bring about the much-needed changes in the world related to equity, the dignity of life etc. The core of the development communication project includes many facets, including communication that it is aimed at:

- The greater good of the society
- It should be inclusive, and no one is left behind
- Has the possibility of bringing social, behavioural change
- It must incorporate the vision of Sustainable development.

A Development Communication Project (henceforth termed DevCom Project) is a meticulously planned exercise created with goals, objectives, purpose, target audiences, etc. It is essential to note that communication as a concept has multiple definitions. Though some aspects and functions of communication may overlap, communication and its purpose have a vital role in the way it is designed. In common understanding, development communication is associated with communicating information and messages, but this may be considered a limited perception. The scope, purpose, and functions of development communication are beyond just communicating messages and information. It must assess the situation and challenges at a community or society level before the required informed disseminated through communication. Engaging stakeholders in the change is the larger objective of any development communication project.

The area of development communication is large with an interdisciplinary nature, which includes meticulous planning. This planning included both elements of research and innovative ways to design strategy, embedded meaning to messages, and engage with social change for the betterment of any society or community. Various experts will describe communication strategy as a concept or domain. Still, in a Dev Com Project, the fine details of communication also include a “dialogic” communication to investigate issues at the beginning of development projects and programs. According to Mefalopulos (2008), ‘engaging stakeholders in assessing key issues helps mitigate risks and prevent the emergence of problems and conflicts before they arise.

As discussed in Unit 13, there are three significant paradigms to development communication. The dominant paradigm, which aimed at development from the perspective of developed nations and ‘modernisation.’ This paradigm encouraged solving development problems by more prosperous, more developed countries. In the last century, development was constantly equated with economic growth. Needless to say that keeping this view in mind, communication was top-down and associated with the dissemination of information and messages aimed at modernizing so-called ‘backwards’ or ‘under-developed or ‘non-modernized’ countries and their people. Mass media were at the centre of communication initiatives to believe that it could persuade and bring change in people’s behaviour patterns as desired.

The Dependency or opposing paradigm was in opposition to the modernisation paradigm. Dependency theorists emphasized the importance of the critical and dynamic link between communication and culture. Though the dependency theory gained significance, it was later considered ineffective since the alternate economic models proposed by its supporters failed.

And lastly, the Emerging paradigm in which the focus of development has shifted from economic growth to include other social dimensions needed to ensure meaningful results in the long run. This paradigm is in line with the change envisaged by the Millennium Development Goals (MDGs). These are the eight international development goals as part of the United Nations millennium declaration. The core of any development should include sustainability and people’s participation. The new paradigm is also changing the way communication is conceived and applied.

Communication and participation go hand in hand for making any development programs, including community-driven ones to be successful. Participation can be incited and meaningful if there is an application of simple two-way communication principles and practices keeping in view the community’s needs. This specific and customized communication (not generic and top-down) is increasingly essential in facilitating stakeholders’ engagement in problem analysis and resolution.

The conventional thought process of the ‘one-size-fits-all’ formula is no longer effective in dealing with people and sensitive issues in today’s age. Diversity and heterogeneity should be acknowledged. The earlier implemented and fundamental principle behind the ‘Sender-Message-Channel-Receiver model’ needs to be re-assessed as the central tower to create a campaign. Change on the ground can be an outcome of many other thoughtful and purposeful actions based on the specifics of the issue concerned. For example, the fight against malnutrition

among children will have a specific variable in African people compared to the Asian community.

Therefore, one notices that development communication has increasingly moved toward a horizontal, “two-way” model. In this model, people are active, and there is direct interaction through consultation and dialogue rather than top-down traditional one-way information dissemination through mass media. Currently, the scope of development communication has broadened to include an analytical aspect and a dialogical one—intended to open public spaces where perceptions, opinions, and knowledge of relevant stakeholders can be aired and assessed.

The changing and evolving landscape of mass communication and digital technology has also enabled a more vibrant ecosystem involving potential stakeholders and target audiences.

Development communication support is also specific to the project. A well-designed communication strategy tends to fail if the project’s overall objectives are not correctly determined and the stakeholders’ point of view is not considered. The communication happens parallel to some offline activities. If the ground activities are not dovetailed with the core of the communication, the Development Communication Project is not adequate even then. Tight deadlines and budget limitations usually encourage or push managers and administrators to rely on communication experts. They also create a short term deadline environment which eventually forces them to act as short-term damage-control public relations. In this case, the entire purpose and foundation of development communication are compromised and neglected. Sometimes, this can cause more damage than benefit to the stakeholders.

Any DevCom Project is a long-term commitment that emerges from intensive research and is supported by a committed team or workforce.

12.1 LEARNING OUTCOMES

After studying this Unit, you should be able to:

- explain the process of implementing the Development Communication Project;
- examine the changing paradigms in Development Communication;
- identify the various steps involved in creating a Development Communication Project; and
- analyze the case study related to development communication.

12.2 WHAT IS DEVELOPMENT COMMUNICATION PROJECT?

We will learn about the development communication project in this section.

12.2.1 Campaign – Meaning and Purpose

A Development Communication Project means a well-charted plan which addresses a specific problem related to socio-economic concern, its impact on a specified audience and creates pathways for the well being of the identified

communities associated or affected by the problem. The project or campaign has a stepwise structure, and at each step, the achievement of the aim/goal is kept intact. It can involve people who are external to the situation, internal members of the community or both.

Development Communication Project involves funding, and this support is commiserating with the scope and duration of the project. In most cases, the main issue is multilayered, and it expects a committed and consistent effort to affect any change.

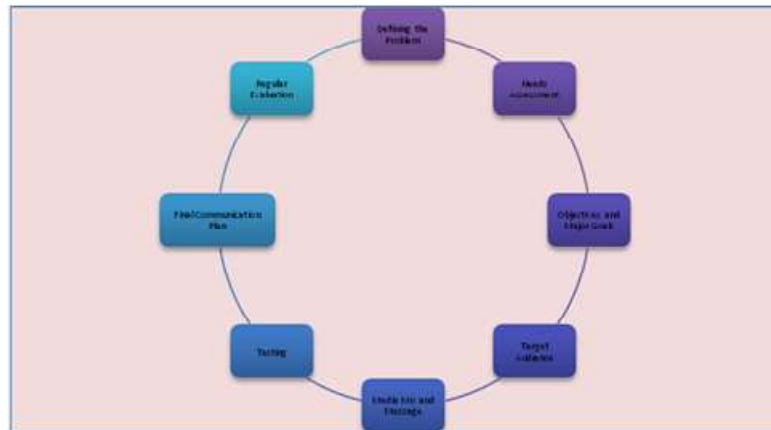
There are multiple approaches to plan and implement a development communication project. These are not stand-alone individual approaches, but they overlap and intersect at many points. Some of these approaches are:

- 1) **Diffusion/extension approach:** This approach results from the Diffusion of Innovations theory, the leading theory post-WWII for agricultural extension. The purpose was concerned with an adoption of a particular technology. In this approach, Everett Rogers developed adopter categories to 'measure' farmers' innovativeness to produce a statistical model (standard distribution curve) to show the distribution of the five-adopter categories over the average time of adoption. Rogers was convinced that the adoption of innovations follows a universal process of social change.
- 2) **Mass Media approach:** In this approach, it is believed that mass media and interpersonal communication is essential for development communication. It is believed that the content of messages should be balanced. It should address both rural and urban and addresses to masses and should be need-based. The mass media approach also considers the mass media infrastructure as a critical component of the process.
- 3) **Development support communication approach:** In this approach, people's motivation and public participation are considered necessary along with the core principles of informing and educating. Public cooperation for national development can occur when there is a common understanding of development plans among the maximum number of people.
- 4) **Integrated approach:** The integrated approach suggests the need to avoid duplication and wastage in development efforts. It stresses the balance in the spread of facilities and reduces the divide between rural and urban areas.
- 5) **Institutional approach:** The focus on education and training is a part of this approach. The importance of literacy, universal education, and adult education is included. Capacity building, training and development-oriented projects or programmes are suggested as a way of achieving the goals.
- 6) **Positive Deviance Approach:** It stems from the diffusion approach. The positive deviance approach stresses that there are examples within the community who are positive deviants and practice ideas, habits or lifestyles that annul the negative impact. These deviants tend to use innovative ways to identify resources within the given set of resources available. Their study and participation in the overall process of DevCom and the outcome generation is very critical.

The success of any development communication project depends on the overall team approach, i.e. the coordination between the communication agencies

(extension workers, media channels like Radio, TV, Press, etc.) etc.) and development agencies.

12.2.2 Basic Steps – Constructing a Communication Strategy



Basic Steps in constructing a communication strategy

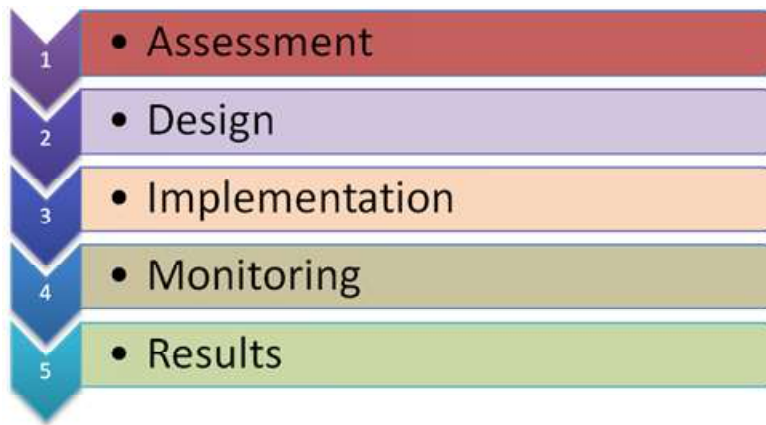
Development Communication is a dynamic process and not stagnant. The communication strategy for any Development Communication Project is very critical. It is continuous in real change being expected in terms of outcomes like behavioural change, process change, and sensitization. The basic steps to create a strategy are:

- 1) Defining the problem: The purpose and aim of the strategy rest on the definition of the problem as it appears to communication strategists.
- 2) Identifying the Needs Assessment
- 3) Defining Objectives and Major Goals
- 4) Identifying Target Audience
- 5) Choosing the optimum Media Mix and connected Message
- 6) Testing
- 7) Final Communication Plan
- 8) Regular Evaluation

Basically, campaigns are implemented in a planned and phased manner. From drawing an action plan to producing and testing samples of media materials, revising and finalising materials, training field staff in content and use of materials, and distributing materials all are important steps to a wholesome plan. The aspect of monitor the campaign remains critical for its success.

12.2.3 Characteristics of a well planned Development Communication Project /Campaign

The primary purpose of most campaigns is to stimulate action on problems requiring short-term changes, which are expected in turn to contribute to broader, long term development goals. The Planning in Phases is depicted pictorially:



Characteristics of well-planned development communication project

i) **Needs assessment/information gathering-** Intensive research

Any Development Communication Project will need to establish its priorities within the larger developmental agenda. These key development priorities need to be identified through intensive research, including field surveys, community consensus, and interviews with field specialists and subject matter specialists.

The initial assessment of the available media channels for potential target groups and the level of technology exposure, sensitization and possibility of technology transfer inputs are also important aspects of the needs assessment phase of a campaign.

The concentration of the team is to prioritize needs. It is essential to select the most critical aspects of development or project objectives to be addressed. This needs assessment indicates the potential target groups. A vital element of any Dev Com Project is to carry out baseline assessment, commonly known as KAP – knowledge, attitudes, practices survey.

ii) **Identification of target group**

The needs assessment exercise is closely related to identifying the human component of the project – which means the issues identified by the people need to be addressed, spoken to, and interacted with within the entire process. The identification of the target group is closely linked to the main plan. For example, if it is a campaign on children and malnutrition, the women in the community will be a key target group.

Another example could be the Swachh Bharat mission and sanitization campaign. Government and agencies could identify target groups based on sub-communities (economic strata, migration status) in a locality rather than solely on gender.

The target audience analysis (KAP or knowledge-attitudes practices indices; literacy levels; access to, use of, and preferred communication channels) are critical because they help in training objectives and streamline the message in the production process.

iii) **The close identification of homogenous groups**

Communication, as discussed earlier, is not a simple give and take of the message but a complex process involving various tangents of the sender

and the receivers ability to understand the message. In the Development Communication Project case, this communication is also intended to create a behavioural change. Therefore, to enable a more effective reception of message incorrect context, identifying homogenous groups within the target audience at the early stages can be a great benefit to the campaign as it progresses. Social interactions are also distinguished based on class, caste, gender divisions.

iv) Focus of the campaign: The needs assessment and identification of the target group help set clear and specific communication campaign objectives and determine multi-media mix and message design strategies. To attain a clear focus, the “success indicators” revealed at the needs assessment stage are targeted. As the project is put in action, these indicators reveal the validation of the project’s achievements.

v) Pre Testing: All good Development Communication Projects have a pre-testing of materials as part of the overall planning. This pre-testing is about earlier research on the target group. Every Target group will have varied exposure to print and visual literacy levels. This knowledge helps choose a medium or media combination which is likely to produce the best results. It is also critical to keep in mind identifying weak levels of knowledge, negative attitudes, and inappropriate practices.

A local perspective to the problem at hand is preferred over an urban lens and top-down approach in creating the pre-testing material.

vi) Training of intermediaries: Most Development Communication projects engage intermediaries, preferably from the community, who act as ambassadors of change. Capacity building and proper training of these members of the team who interact ‘on the ground’ is a significant step to good planning.

Objective Monitoring: Development Communication projects by the nature of their intent and purpose always require objective monitoring either by internal or external team sources. As the campaign unfolds, monitoring and small-scale field evaluations can accurately point to where emphasis should be redirected, or where content units need reinforcement.

The final post-campaign impact evaluations can add to quantitative and qualitative results for comparison and become a future reference for subsequent interventions in the same area.

viii) Content and tenor of the messages: A good Development Communication project will always be sensitive to the content created and the embedded message. Regional and cultural sensibilities are kept in mind not to cause damage to the purpose of the campaign. The current campaigns also ensure that there is a vital component of sustainability included in the communication.

ix) Choose Appropriate Channels: Any campaign, which doesn’t choose the right platform faces the threat of failing in its purpose to effect the change. For example, the rural audiences in India have a different set of media platforms than the urban Indian metropolitan population. Pretesting messages and programs is a good option.

- x) **Engage all stakeholders in implementation:** While identifying the target audience, key emphasis must also be paid to the stakeholders and influencers in the community. Their involvement in the project will ensure greater and willing participation. For example, the Sarpanch in an Indian village or a local mid wife for a project on reducing female foeticide.
- xi) **Create milestones for assessment and review:** A constant review mechanism should be in place. Team members with a good amount of experience are most suited to charter this aspect of the project implementation.
- xii) **Flexibility to re-strategize if needed:** Both the plan and the team need to be flexible in realigning the strategy based on the campaign's final goal. The rigidity of both message and process can be harmful in the long run.
- xiii) **Comprehensive data for future interventions:** To truly achieve the inherent goal of development, all the data from a campaign should be preserved for future use.

Check Your Progress Exercise 1

Notes: 1) Use the space below for your answer.

2) Compare your answers with those given at the end of this Unit.

- 1) What are the steps in developing a communication strategy for a Development Communication Project?

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- 2) How important is it to choose the appropriate channels in any Development Communication campaign?

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- 3) Discuss any two characteristics of a well-planned project.

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12.3 MEDIA MIX

Communication is the most basic and essential element in the process of development. In the technology age that we live in, communication is multifaceted and includes traditional mass media platforms like Print, TV, Radio, telecommunications, information and communication technologies (ICTs), interpersonal communication etc.

The purpose and goal of communication which supports development is:

- 1) inform,
- 2) educate
- 3) and motivate people.

The aspects of entertainment are not avoided but reoriented to promote induce behaviour change that contributes toward national development.

Media Mix refers to the combination of platforms or channels used for the communication within a Development Communication campaign. Media is one of the most critical influencers if correctly used as per the nuances of the project and the target audiences.

The specific channel or media mix, which is selected for use, depends on several factors like:

- objectives of the communication intervention. i.e. is it for awareness, advocacy, sensitization etc
- specific attributes and characteristics of the audiences? i.e. literacy, presence of media, etc
- the social environment, for example, cultural context and available resources

The basic know-how of each medium of communication and its specific strength is essential for the communication specialist. Each medium has its strength and weakness.

For example; Radio is a suitable medium for those who may not be literate. Often, Radio is the preferred medium in rural settings television is known for its high appeal for entertainment. TV can attract attention in awareness programs. The print medium, including newspapers and periodicals, can be effective in population or sample size where the community members are literate and can read and write. Usually, development projects aim at the marginalized. In such cases, a print medium may not be a suitable choice.

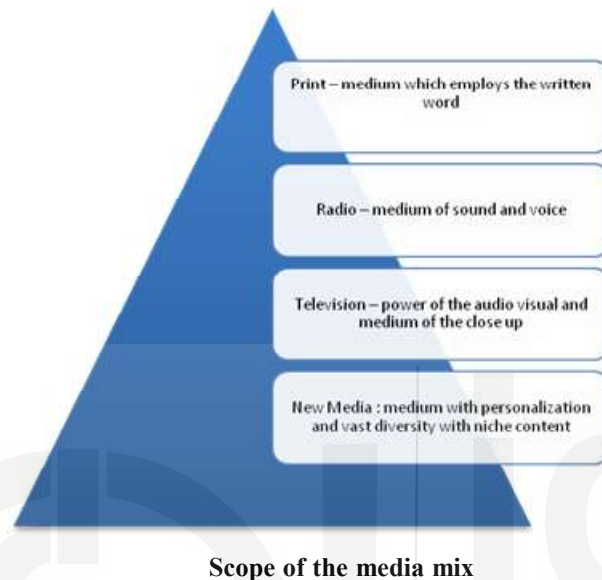
In countries like India with a rich, diverse and local heritage, traditional forms of communication, such as storytelling or famous theatre, is very effective in discussing sensitive issues. Folk artists are also considered influencers in some cultures and communities. Embedding messages within semi-rigid folk forms creates a great capacity to induce change in the audience's attitudes and behaviours gradually. Whichever medium or channel is selected, it is essential to have a sound justification and rationale for choosing it. The correct and optimum communication mix is crucial.

New information technologies such as the Internet or social media are the new channels for communication specialists. They are and will provide a broader

range of options in the future since personalization and the essence of dialogue and feedback are possible. This is unlike the conventional one-way mediums like Radio and television. Community Radio or CR is an exception.

Therefore, it is essential to discuss and define all the elements of strategy and then implement the message design activities.

12.3.1 Meaning of Media Mix



- **Print – a medium which employs the written word**

In India, the Government widely uses print media (national, regional and local dailies) to secure comprehensive coverage of messages through various newspapers and journals. Print media has a considerable impact on literate populations.

In India, print media has a unique composition. This includes the national dailies as well as regional newspapers and periodicals. Newspapers in Marathi, Malayalam, Bengali and many other languages are famous in their specific regions. They have been effectively used for development communication campaigns, especially by the State governments, to reach as many people as possible.

- **Radio – medium of sound and voice**

Radio has played an essential role in the development of communication. It is a preferred medium, which allows a forum for discussion and dialogue of issues, concepts, countering prejudices and proposing skills for a better life. Radio in India has a rich history of participating as a collaborator for development communication. In post-independent India, radio broadcast was done in different languages to promote development communication. Programs specifically designed for Rural audiences, Unique Educational Programs and Family Welfare Programs have been a part of programming structure since then, at least within the national broadcasters like All India Radio (AIR).

In the past, AIR has been the forerunner in implementing communication strategies adopted by the incumbent government. A very historical

intervention, which covered 156 villages, was the Radio Rural Forum experiment of 1956. It included a 30-minute duration program that was aired two days a week, primarily on agriculture. This show also included varied other subjects aimed to promote rural development. Since the impact of Radio has been positive and has shown results, efforts are constantly made to use Radio for social change. Adult literacy was a crucial issue in the 1980s wherein Radio was chosen as the medium to inform audiences on the value of being literate.

- **Television – the audiovisual combination and medium of the close-up**

Television is a prevalent mass medium from the start. It is the source of education, information and entertainment to the middle class in India. Television was used in a planned manner to motivate people during the period when there was a single broadcaster to participate in developmental programs.

A great strength of television is creating proximity and attention in the audience's mind with visuals and audio. The power of the close up also allows it to leave an impression on the subconscious, thus making it an attractive choice for development. Today the space is cluttered, but there is loyalty to niche channels. This can also be an asset to announce, discuss and motivate change for the issue at hand. On the other hand, too many channels can be considered a reason for segmented audiences.

- **New Media: medium with personalization and vast diversity with niche content**

Today, new media has become an active tool of development communication. Computers or Information Technology entered the Indian Society around 1986. The actual transition in India happened after 1996 when several independent media houses brought out news websites. Interactivity, instant feedback, and persuasion capability are distinct qualities and can grab the ordinary person's attention to issues and agendas of development. This is the fastest and most evolving medium of communication.

12.3.2 Role of Community Radio

As discussed earlier, Radio is a powerful medium of supporting causes of development communication projects. Radio, from its very inception, played an important role. This is mainly due to its advantage of reaching many people from different sections of society. The community radio (CR) segment is of further relevance. Unlike the national channels, which broadcast and have limited dialogue with immediate communities, the CR sector has the advantage of operating within a restricted geographical area with specific socio-cultural aspects. In India, for example, Universities and other educational institutes, especially agricultural universities, through their extension networks and international organisations under the UN umbrella, carried various development communication experiments through Radio.

Community radio is registering growing importance, especially in rural India. Selected NGOs and Krishi Vigyan Kendras (KVK) have been given license to set up a local community radio station to broadcast information and messages on developmental aspects. Participation of the local community is encouraged in these programs.

The CR station gives a platform to villagers to narrowcast local issues and can incite positive action. Several initiatives have been made to use Radio for development communication with its specific reach and cultural acceptability among the rural audiences. Issues concerning women and legal rights, farmer distress, government-supported schemes, and day-to-day and seasonal needs of the local community are regularly part of these programs. During worldwide calamities like the COVID pandemic, CR stations across India reached out to their audiences with messages of hygiene and sanitization.

Community radio is aimed at giving voice to the voiceless. It is imagined as a truly democratic platform – of the people, people, and people. The purpose of establishing CR stations is in line with the goal of development, and the stations aim at creating content for the benefit of society.

Check Your Progress Exercise 2

Notes: 1) Use the space below for your answer.

2) Compare your answers with those given at the end of this Unit.

1) Describe the term Media Mix

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2) What is the criterion for choosing a specific channel or media mix? Mention any two factors

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3) Identify two advantages of using community radio for development campaigns?

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12.4 SOCIAL MEDIA: INNOVATIVE AND PARTICIPATORY DIMENSIONS

Social media, in simple terms, implies the multitude of websites and applications that enable users to participate in social networking. These platforms enabled by digital technology also allow users to create and share content both in visual such as text and image or audio forms.

The internet of things (IoT) has changed many aspects of human life since the new millennial worldwide and India. IoT has revolutionized the way people in society interact with one another through social media.

Digital technology and its impact have inspired various countries' governments to look at the positives of using technology for larger purposes of policy dissemination and connecting to people far and wide through various digital platforms. India is one of the biggest democracies of the world, as well as a growing economy. The IoT market in India is projected to grow at a CAGR of more than 28.2 per cent during 2016-2022.

India already has a strong base in technology, and the public-industry partnership is bound to bring about a monumental change. One of India's most notable IoT initiatives will be to integrate technology for delivering health, education, and financial services to remote areas. The divide between rural and urban India with IoT can be bridged by technology enablement and access in all policy planning and development initiatives.

The public-industry partnership is also an integral part of the overall development of any country. Another common term used for the current period in human civilization is referred to as Industry 4.0. Industry 4.0 represents a new stage in the organisation and control of the industrial value chain. This refers to **the digital transformation of manufacturing/production and related industries and all value creation processes.**

Digital India Campaign is one of the initiatives of the Government of India to promote the value of digital technology and encourage its practical use. According to government website digitalindia.gov.in, Digital India is a flagship programme of the Government of India with a vision to transform India into a digitally empowered society and knowledge economy.

One of the Digital India campaign highlights is the high level of interest evinced by tech giants to partner with the Indian Government. Accelerating digital literacy as part of '*Ek Kadam Unnati Ki Aur*' offers promise for DevCom campaigns.

As more and more people get acquainted with digital technology, innovative telephony, communication through social media networks will also prosper. Social networks are slowly becoming a powerful way of meeting like-minded people and generating ideas. Gradually, social networks are beginning to have a more significant role in building community. They can enable action and catalyze cooperation.

Using social media is now considered a viable part of a development communication campaign. Some of the advantages are:

- Propagation of the message using low-cost online methods
- Circulation on the broader community and large numbers
- Ownership of the stakeholders in propagating a message related to the broader campaign
- Accessibility of national-level campaign in local languages

Social media has created civic awareness, the role of government in handling critical issues, allowed citizens to highlight issues of concern and raise public consciousness. These attributes can allow social media to be a viable medium of change for development if used optimally and cautiously.

12.5 LET US SUM UP

To summarize, dialogue or two-way communication, if used from the inception of a development initiative, is essential to generate positive results, and involvement of all stakeholders and a diverse media mix that includes two-way communication is effective. The importance of experts and specialists should also be understood. Their rich knowledge of the problem, its various facets, target audience, along with a distinct variety of methods, techniques, and tools of development communication, will generate valuable additions leading to positive results.

Development Communication projects are essential elements to the development paradigm. A DevCom Project means a well-charted plan initiated by a Government or Non-Government agency that addresses a specific problem related to socio-economic concern, its impact on a specified audience, and creates pathways for the identified communities' well-being affected by the problem. The project or campaign has a stepwise structure, and at each step, the achievement of the aim/goal is kept intact. It can involve people who are external to the situation, internal members of the community or both.

There are dynamic projects that begin from the process of needs assessment and finish at evaluation and suggest different paths to continue and sustain the change generated. Sustainable development is the current concern of leaders and civil society, and dev com projects are being devised and strategized to incorporate this aspect of suitability.

There are many steps involved in designing a project. This involves communication experts along with concerned stakeholders. With the advent of digital technology, social media is fast becoming a site of communicating content about development and associated social welfare schemes. The government of India has also identified the potential of the digital domain. Social networks are slowly becoming a powerful way of meeting like-minded people and generating ideas. Gradually, social networks are beginning to have a more significant role in building community. They can enable action and catalyze cooperation

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12.7 ANSWER TO CHECK YOUR PROGRESS EXERCISES

Check Your Progress Exercise 1

- 1) The steps in developing a communication strategy for a Development Communication Project are:
 - Defining the problem: The purpose and aim of the strategy rests on the definition of the problem as it appears to communication strategists, Identifying the Needs Assessment, Defining Objectives and Major Goals, Identifying Target Audience, Choosing the optimum Media Mix and connected Message, Testing, Final Communication Plan and Regular Evaluation
- 2) It is essential to choose the right channels for the dissemination of the message within the target audience. Any campaign, which doesn't choose the right platform faces the threat of failing in its purpose to effect the change. For example, the rural audiences in India have a different set of media platforms than the urban Indian metropolitan population. Pretesting messages and programs is a good option.
- 3) The two characteristics of a well-planned projector:

i) **Identification of target group**

The needs assessment exercise is closely related to identifying the human component of the project – which means the people identified to be addressed, spoken to, and interacted with within the entire process. The identification of the target group is closely linked to the main agenda. For example, if it is a campaign on children and malnutrition, the women in the community will be a key target group.

The target audience analysis (KAP or knowledge-attitudes practices indices; literacy levels; access to, use of, and preferred communication channels) are critical because they help in training objectives and streamline the message in the production process.

ii) **The close identification of homogenous groups**

Communication, as discussed earlier, is not a simple give and take of

the message but a complex process involving various tangents of the sender and the receivers ability to understand the message. In the case of DevCom Project, this communication is also intended to create a behavioural change. Therefore, to enable a more effective reception of message incorrect context, identifying homogenous groups within the target audience at the early stages can be a great benefit to the campaign as it progresses.

Check Your Progress Exercise 2

- 1) Media Mix refers to the combination of platforms or channels used for the communication within a Development Communication campaign. Media is one of the most critical influencers if correctly used as per the nuances of the project and the target audiences.
- 2) The specific channel or media mix which is selected for use depends on several factors like:
 - objectives of the communication intervention. i.e. is it for awareness, advocacy, sensitization etc
 - specific attributes and characteristics of the audiences. i.e literacy, presence of media, etc.
 - the social environment, for example, cultural context and available resources
- 3) a) Unlike the national channels, which broadcast and have limited dialogue with immediate communities, the CR sector has the advantage of operating within a restricted geographical area with specific socio-cultural aspects.
- b) The CR station gives a platform to villagers to narrowcast local issues and has excellent potential to incite positive action.

Check Your Progress Exercise 3

- 1) Digital India is a flagship programme of the Government of India with a vision to transform India into a digitally empowered society and knowledge economy.
- 2) As more and more people get acquainted with digital technology, innovative telephony, communication through social media networks will also prosper. Social networks are slowly becoming a powerful way of meeting like-minded people and generating ideas. Gradually, social networks are beginning to have a more significant role in building community. They can enable action and catalyze cooperation. Using social media is now considered a viable part of a development communication campaign. Some of the advantages are:
 - Propagation of the message using low-cost online methods
 - Circulation on the broader community and large numbers
 - Ownership of the stakeholders in propagating a message related to the broader campaign
 - Accessibility of national-level campaign in local languages

Social media has created civic awareness, the role of government in handling critical issues, allowed citizens to highlight issues of concern and raise public consciousness. These attributes can allow social media to be a viable medium of change for development if used optimally and cautiously.

UNIT 13 CORPORATE SOCIAL RESPONSIBILITY (CSR) FOR DEVELOPMENT

Structure

- 13.0 Introduction
- 13.1 Learning Outcomes
- 13.2 Corporate Social Responsibility
 - 13.2.1 Definitions CSR
 - 13.2.2 Benefits of CSR
 - 13.2.3 Theory of CSR
- 13.3 History of CSR
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13.0 INTRODUCTION

Corporates do not work in isolation. Along with their employees and consumers, they also work with other businesses, government, local authorities, and the general public. All these are the stakeholders, not shareholders. A stakeholder is not directly connected to the business but could and would be affected by it at some point in time.

Businesses these days understand the value of community relations as well as environmental sustainability. Apart from working on the product/ service directly for profit, businesses can even choose to work on the issues (social, environmental, developmental) related to the product or service they deal in. Every business understands the significance of image in the long run, and Corporate Social Responsibility (CSR) initiatives give them a platform to enhance their image in the eyes of the stakeholders.

In this Unit, we will discuss in detail CSR and its business connection. We will also study the role of stakeholders and how a Corporate fulfils its responsibilities

toward them. Topics like corporate Governance and its interrelation with CSR will also be covered in this Unit.

13.1 LEARNING OUTCOMES

After studying this Unit, you should be able to

- define the term ‘CSR and stakeholders’;
- trace the history of CSR;
- understand the benefits of CSR;
- discuss the various publics of CSR; and
- comprehend the interrelation between CSR and Corporate Governance.

13.2 CORPORATE SOCIAL RESPONSIBILITY

This term ‘Corporate Social Responsibility might be new to you, or maybe that you have a vague understanding of what it entails. In this section, let us try to gain insight into what it precisely means. We shall define the term and also go through its theory. Let us also see why it is beneficial and what are the advantages of engaging in socially responsible behavioural practices for a corporate? We shall now on use the acronym CSR for the term.

13.2.1 Defining CSR

CSR is a system for corporates that ensures the responsibility of businesses towards society. This covers the financial, legal, and unrestricted exceptions that the public has of a corporate. It is a wholesome business concept to have sustainable growth by taking care of all the stakeholders by providing financial, communal and environmental benefits.

It is a practice to take social responsibility as a corporate and act on it through various CSR initiatives. CSR aims to positively impact various social issues related to customers, internal publics, society, and anyone in public scope who may be considered stakeholders. It is a way of giving back to the society in which you operate and earn from.

CSR involves managing a business in a legal, ethical, and meets the commercial and social expectations.

It is a corporate method that supports social development by providing financial and social aids for all the public. CSR is a concept with many descriptions and practices.

Let us look at some of the pivotal definitions of the term

Howard Bowen defines CSR as: “It refers to the obligations of businessmen to pursue those policies, to make those decisions, or to follow those lines of action which are desirable in terms of the objectives and values of our society. “

Archie B Carroll offers the following definition: “The social responsibility of business encompasses the economic, legal, ethical, and discretionary expectations that society has of organisations at a given point in time.”

According to the UNIDO, “Corporate social responsibility is a management concept whereby companies integrate social and environmental concerns in their business operations and interactions with their stakeholders. CSR is generally understood as to how a company achieves a balance of economic, environmental, and social imperatives”.

Like any other concept, CSR is also an evolving term. Earlier, it was termed just any other extra-curricular activity other than the corporate’s economic, technical or legal necessity. Now, the definition of CSR goes beyond this and is better described as a strong sense of social responsibility towards the public attached to it.

In India, in 2013, an amendment was made in the Company Act - Section 135, making it compulsory to spend at least 2 per cent of average net profits for CSR during the three immediately prior or following fiscal years at any time for corporates. However, not all corporates come under this rule. Corporates having a net value of Rs 5 billion or more, companies with a turnover of Rs 10 billion or more or having a net profit of Rs 50 million and above during any single financial year come under this Act.

Corporate with earnings, as mentioned above, have to spend 2 per cent of the average net profit for CSR activities. This step was taken to ensure those big corporates making huge profits take CSR seriously and be held accountable if they fail to do so.

Various corporates use different approaches to conduct their CSR activities. Most popular CSR activities include educational and health promotional programs. An in-house foundation with the staff participating as volunteers is also a principal activity as it generates a lot of media attention. Programs related to issues like gay rights, eradicating elephantiasis disease or cleft palate are used less as they are precise in terms of the target audience. It reduces the scope of a CSR activity to a particular area or community.

Let us study an example: TATA group carries out numerous CSR activities in various spheres. Some programs focus on community improvement and some on improving the lives of people living in poverty. The group participates in women empowerment programs, rural community development, and other prosperity programs through various NGOs. They also provide scholarships and donations to various educational institutions.

TATA also engages in healthcare programs like immunisation, awareness of AIDS etc. Climate change, sports, building hospitals, educational institutes, sports academies etc., are a few other areas where TATA contributes under their CSR initiatives. With this example, we can understand that under the CSR umbrella, a lot of programmes and activities can be done at various levels.

13.2.2 Benefits of CSR

CSR has become an integral part of today’s corporate culture. It is much more than just a law or mandate. It brings life to the so-called living organism known as “corporate”. With CSR, a corporate ensures its overall growth and positive reputation. CSR offers numerous paybacks both outwardly and within the corporate.

If we talk about the external benefits of CSR on a large scale, it can create short-term job opportunities through various community-based programs like building a local park or a sports centre. Plantations and cultivation programs are highly appreciated in areas where the plantation is less or adversely affected by some climatic conditions. Steps like recycling are also well received by the public as it helps the environment and waste management.

Internal benefits are for the internal publics, like employees. Besides attracting and retaining the best talent in the industry, CSR serves as an addition to the routine work and gives a feeling of purpose to a company's employees while doing their regular job. Besides this, CSR also helps in business sustainability, competitive lead and easier compliance with governing obligations.

To understand the benefits of CSR further, let us see what else it brings to the table:

1) Public image

Corporates that establish their commitment to various CSR activities are perceived as more humanitarian than others. However, one needs to remember that initiating CSR activities is not enough. Corporates have to make sure that the public notices them, and only then will their image be benefited. It is as simple as that. Anyone and everyone would like to get involved with someone with a good reputation. If given a choice, the customer will buy from someone who helps society too. A Corporate can create a positive image by connecting with NGOs through financial donations, employee volunteers, and donations of products/services and making the public aware of their contribution. In a nutshell, well thought out CSR activities advance a corporate public image and its connection with customers.

2) Media Exposure

If you need a public reaction, you must make people aware of your efforts. If no one knows about the efforts, a corporate is putting in CSR initiatives, and the CSR activity will not reach its full potential. CSR can give an excellent platform to a corporate in media. Strategically planned CSR activities lead to significant media coverage and strong media relations. And we all know, news stories create a better image than any advertisements. However, the corporate should be prepared that media will keep a close eye on all the past work and future endeavours once in the limelight. In a nutshell, a well-planned CSR program is the gateway to good media coverage and positive portrayal.

3) Employee Retention

Every employee wants to work with a corporate that has an ethical conscience. It is suitable for morale and overall growth. Being associated with a name with strong values and is known for its commitment to society is encouraging for an employee. And happy employees mean better results. Also, it helps in retaining employees in today's competitive world. To be precise, CSR helps in attracting and retaining the best talent in the business.

4) **Attract and Hold Investors**

Investors are the people who bring money into a business; without them, no one can succeed. The ones who give money want to know how their funds are being used. Investors ask for a sound business plan and profits from the corporate and a sturdy CSR plan for the long run. They understand that it is not only profit that matters in business over a more extended period. When a corporation is associated with a cause and encourages its employees to be a part of its initiatives, it motivates the investor to go that extra mile and strengthen future associations.

Investors are more likely to be invested with corporate that upkeep an assurance to their employees and customers and CSR initiatives that impact society. That means the investor pays more attention to socially responsible corporate.

5) **Community Support**

Along with the internal and external publics, the community plays a vital role for any business establishment. Businesses understand that even after clearing all the legal formalities, it will be challenging to operate smoothly without community support.

An apt example here would be - the TATA Nano plant in Singur, West Bengal. Tata started their plant in Singur to manufacture their small wonder "TATA NANO". The farmland laws undertaken by the State government under the land acquisition Act led to controversy. This started a protest by farmers, opposition, and social activists. The whole project was under attack and immense pressure by protesting farmers. Mamata Banerjee launched a movement, 'Save Farmland,' to support the protesters. The whole situation turned so intense that despite the State government's support, Tata had to shift the whole operations of the Plant to Sanand, Gujarat, in October 2008.

13.2.3 **Theory of CSR**

In this section, let us look at the various theories that have been academically bred over the concept of CSR:

Stakeholder Theory

A stakeholder is a person who has a stake in the business. If the stake is significant, the bigger the risk. In simple words, at stake means at risk when it comes to business. To put the Stakeholder theory in simplest form, we can say that - those whose lives are affected by a corporate/business have a right and responsibility to participate in guiding it.

Various theorists think that Stakeholder theory is kind of a replica of CSR. Instead of having an inward approach, it starts from the outside world. It describes all the groups/communities that will be affected by the business directly or indirectly. This theory talks about who are legitimate stakeholders, their rights etc. Also, what kind of expectations they can have from a particular business.

Let us understand it with an example: There is a hospital in a local town, and it produces medical waste daily, which needs to be disposed of safely. It is the moral and legal responsibility of the hospitals to do so Corporate Social

Responsibly for the safety of the environment and public. However, as per the stakeholder theory: it starts with the community around people living in the hospital's vicinity. They might be adversely affected by medical waste if it is not disposed of safely. The community around the hospital has a right to a clean environment. Therefore, they are stakeholders for the hospital and can demand proper dumping of medical waste. If we see purely from work matter, they do not have any right on the hospital as they are not directly attached. However, they do have a moral claim to be a part of decision making when it comes to disposing of medical waste. This is the most crucial point in this theory. People affected by a business get attached to it as a stakeholder and enjoy some status in the decision-making process.

Now the question arises, who are the stakeholders? Well, it depends on business to business. For a chemical producing business in a small town of UP, the list of stakeholders could be the following:

- Proprietors (individual or shareholders)
- Employees
- Customers and probable customers
- Suppliers and probable suppliers
- People living in the town
- Financial institutions
- Government
- Competition

Some of the stakeholders as mentioned above, could be primary; some could be secondary.

If we look closely, we will find that in some broad sense, everyone is a stakeholder. We all share air and land, so anything with the potential to affect us in any manner makes us a stakeholder. This gives us the right to question and demand answers as and when by any business around. However, on practical grounds, stakeholders are defined as directly affected by business decisions and not everyone. For example, in the Bhopal Gas Tragedy, everyone was a stakeholder who lived in Bhopal and nearby areas. When it came to the compensation, it was only given to people who were visibly affected by it, and not everyone presents in Bhopal that day.

The fundamental of the stakeholder theory is that since the society extends an implied consent to the business to operate, it also has a reasonable right to support or criticize the business if it feels endangered in any way.

Check Your Progress Exercise 1

Notes: 1) Use the space below for your answer.

2) Compare your answers with those given at the end of this Unit.

- 1) CSR is a way for corporate to work towards holistic development (T/F)
- 2) In the year _____, an amendment was made in the Company Act, section _____ to make CSR compulsory for corporate.
- 3) How much a corporate has to spend on CSR as per the company law in India? _____

- 4) Corporates having a net value of _____ or more, companies with a turnover of _____ or more or the ones having a net profit of _____ and above during any single financial year, come under this Act.

13.3 HISTORY OF CSR

What we know and understand of CSR today has gone through its evolution process. In India, a major change happened in 2013 and across the world the practice has been evolving either due to ethical behaviours or societal demands or formal laws. Let us see the process of growth of CSR over time in this section.

13.3.1 Emergence of CSR

The industrial revolution brought mass production and hence the need to keep and retain workers by factories. Then, the businesses took care of their employees so that the production can be increased and profits maximised. This could be considered as a business decision for increasing production or an idea for stakeholder welfare. There was no exact definition at that time to segregate welfare and gains.

In the 1800s, philanthropy started emerging. However, it was still difficult to draw a line between the individual master's wish to do good or a profit-generating business decision by the owner. A lot of good work was undertaken by the business houses. However, it was never concretised and seen as social responsibility or philanthropy. It was often considered goodwill, religious or employee-friendly Act. Most of the activities were about endorsing arts, building religious buildings or donations to educational establishments etc.

Many researchers believe that CSR, as we know it today, started taking shape in the 1950s.

Patrick Murphy divided CSR into four time periods before and after the 1950s:

- Everything before the 1950s comes under the 'philanthropic' period.
- 1953-67: This era is named as 'awareness era' where businesses started acknowledging the inclusive social responsibility
- 1968-73: This period is known as 'issue'. Here businesses started recognizing issues they want to work with. Issues like discrimination, climate change, poverty etc.
- 1978-the 80s: Finally, this is the 'responsiveness' period. And during and after this period, businesses started taking CSR initiatives as a severe management task.

Nevertheless, it is tough to define precise periods about the categorisations mentioned above; Patrick's explanation is convenient and broadly consistent.

If we talk about the modern version of CSR as we know it, the Corporate credit Social Responsibility will go to Howard Bowen. In 1953, he published the book 'Social Responsibilities of the Businessman', which raised many right questions and talked about social responsibility (SR). One particular question that was relevant is: what responsibilities towards society can businesspeople reasonably be expected to assume?

He was the first one who tried to define CSR or SR, which was commonly used earlier. Bowman wrote how business is becoming powerful and playing a more significant role in decision making, and with power comes the responsibility towards society. He also mentioned that CSR is no magic formula for all social problems. It can only guide businesses in future to act responsibly. The definition given in his book works as the base for most of the Morden definitions of CSR.

This book added so much to streamline the concept of CSR that some treat Howard Bowman as the father of CSR.

However, this whole era was more about the talks and less of action. This was the time when businesses were opening up to the idea of CSR.

1980s and '90s saw legitimate attempts begin to make corporate adopt CSR policies. It was an effort to streamline the whole process and make corporate accountable. In the 1992 Earth summit, 48 corporate came voluntarily forward to set an example of commitment towards the environment. This step was taken to increase voluntary participation in social causes.

Though it was a little later that corporate started to understand the power of CSR as a vital image-building activity. In 1995, when a considerable corporate was accused of harming the environment and had to resort to extreme measures to cover it up, many corporate began to understand that they need to maintain reputation, and CSR can play a vital role in winning public trust.

In today's time, CSR has reached its pinnacle in terms of its importance. Corporate understood the role of CSR not only for the benefit of stakeholders but also for maintaining business in the long run.

13.3.2 Emergence of CSR in India

India is the country that used the law to make CSR mandatory for corporate. The new Company Act, 2013 was introduced to make it happen.

However, the will and action of CSR is not new for India, and it has its share of philanthropy in the past. CSR has evolved in terms of definition, scope and reach with the growth of the Indian economy and its corporate.

It began as charity or philanthropy work of businesses. The driving force was mainly religious or traditional rather than well planned CSR activity. The charity trend was more about donations towards temples or food for poor people. It was more about helping only when needed and not regularly. And most of the donation or philanthropy work was guided by caste, religion or political point of view.

In the 19th century, when big business corporate-like TATA's and Birla's came into being, the need and intent was strongly felt for social development along with business growth.

During the freedom struggle, stress was on Indian industries to show their support to help the society. Mahatma Gandhi tried to guild the businesses in this direction by introducing the concept of 'Trusteeship'. He wanted to end the cut-throat ideas of new-found capitalism from the vision of Indian industrialists. Trusteeship was a socio-economic idea where Gandhi Ji said that business owners or wealthy individuals should trust some other trusts and look after the public. With this

idea, he wanted wealthy people to share their fortune with the needy to better society. The Marxist approach of socialism was dominant in such measures. Gandhi's ideas inspired many businesses to work towards the social and financial development of the nation. Significant contributions were made to support Gandhi's philosophy on Nai Talim, Dalit Empowerment, women empowerment etc.

After independence, when India rose to the ideas of mixed economy and Public Service Undertakings (PSU) were introduced, the private sector did not work at the forefront of CSR. New laws related to labour and the environment were introduced, setting the tone for CSR in India. The PSUs were established with the motive of qualified distribution of resources. Nevertheless, they were effective only to a certain level when it came to CSR. This turned the tide towards the private and individually owned companies to take better initiatives towards CSR.

The 90's witnessed businesses are becoming courageous to think beyond traditional CSR activities. They had started looking at it as a management process. They started seeing CSR as a sustainable corporate approach. Globalisation and economic liberalization supported this thought process and approached CSR. India holds an important position in new business markets, and many new ventures started coming up every year.

A lot of socially responsible work was being done by both Indian origin businesses and MNC's. However, most of the activities or initiatives remained for the namesake and did not match the true spirit of CSR. Some even did it purely for the sake of PR and media coverage. CSR in India had yet to evolve to reach its true potential.

Check Your Progress Exercise 2

Notes: 1) Use the space below for your answer.

2) Compare your answers with those given at the end of this Unit.

1) Define the period between 1968-73 concerning CSR.

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2) Many researchers believe that CSR as we know it now started taking shape in the _____.

3) Who is referred to as the father of CSR?

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13.4 PUBLICS OF CSR

When it comes to the stakeholders or shareholders directly or indirectly affected by a company's activities, they are all referred to as Publics. You have already gone through the internal and external publics' concept in the Unit on Public Relations. Let us understand in this Section, the concept concerning CSR:

13.4.1 Government

There is a direct relationship between the CSR activities by a Corporate and the Government Guidelines. Government policies immensely shape the regulation of businesses.

Government policies related to a business assert that: any business procedures shall not damage the public and the climate. Organisations should live in harmony with the public and surroundings. To ensure the following, the government passes laws to observe both the conduct and operations. Some monetary fine or another form of punishment is also there for businesses that violate the law.

Governments offer companies several endowments and incentives because they meet the terms of regulations and policies. Some studies indicate that a very high percentage of businesses have shown additional benefits by adhering to government policies.

Lastly, governments control businesses to safeguard stakeholders' and shareholders' interests. In the absence of these regulations and policies, people's interests could be exploited by money-minded businesses. Also, these policies protect the business from public misconduct and illegal interference.

With policies, the government tries to balance the Act of profit-making and social responsibilities.

There are some criticisms and counterpoints to this interference of government into the CSR policies. Some disapprove of the whole concept of CSR and claim that it is government responsibility to ensure the development of society. Businesses are there to make a profit and not for the welfare of the people. Critics of CSR argue upon many apprehensions, including CSR's affiliation to the ultimate nature of business (profit) and questionable motivations for engaging in CSR activities (only because of law) and worries about insincerity and deceit.

13.4.2 Society

Let us learn what is in CSR for Society?

We have talked about how CSR benefits a corporate and improves the image of the business. Now we are going to discuss the value of CSR from a societal point of view. Do CSR initiatives bring a positive change, or is it just a more ethical term for PR/marketing and greenwash?

Studies have shown that a corporation should focus on a positive outcome rather than media coverage regarding CSR initiatives. An honest CSR engagement can encourage new consumers, ensure loyalty and sturdier brand acknowledgement in the long run.

However, the counter view is that many corporates use CSR to gain financial profits from such obligation, irrespective of the social welfares. Thus, CSR initiatives fall short of their possible social effect since helping the public was never the corporates' planned outcome.

Accountable CSR activities of a corporate may motivate the public to do the same in their lives and community. This kind of social stimulation may empower them to gain emotional benefits from helping other people.

Corporate success by implementing successful CSR activities is a success for the local community too. A successful company could hire more workforce from the local community with better pay and facilities.

CSR activities are the best way for a corporate to contribute directly to society and the public. Through any local/national level contribution, a corporate can help the community. A corporate can directly take social initiatives like health programs for people under the poverty line, working with beggars, etc. They can work with an NGO in fields in line with its mission and vision.

While choosing what cause or area to work with, a corporate goes in the direction to relate it to their primary business. For example, a food chain can donate all the leftover food to some orphanage or people living on the streets. This can solve leftover food, and a CSR activity is also accomplished without much hassle.

After businesses choose to make constructive contributions to the public, they benefit the corporate in the process. Today almost all corporates use CSR initiatives for better sales, valuable brand identity and loyal consumers.

Nestle can be a good case in the perspective mentioned above. Nestle uses a powerful tagline that entirely supports the brand's motto- 'Good food - Good Life'. It is not just a tagline used for endorsing the brand; it essentially condenses their CSR initiatives and conveys their vow to improve community health.

Check Your Progress Exercise 3

Notes: 1) Use the space below for your answer.

2) Compare your answers with those given at the end of this Unit.

- 1) Development is the responsibility of the government and not the corporate. (T/F)
- 2) CSR initiatives lead to benefits like better sales, valuable brand and loyal consumers. (T/F)
- 3) Good CSR is the key to better government relations/government PR. (T/F)

13.5 CSR PROCESS

Now that you understand that CSR is an essential part of business development and lawfully guided, you would be thinking of questions like What are the steps to plan and execute a CSR campaign? How to decide what to do and then how to implement it? What are the right ways to Corporate Social Responsibly measure the success of the initiatives?

Let us resolve your curiosities and discuss what is to be done and how in this Section:

13.5.1 Planning and Developing

Let us first understand that there is no generic or 'one fits all' plan CSR method. Every plan or process depends on the individual corporate, needs, community, and current situations. Also, these plans can be changed at any stage if required. Each plan will be different in terms of focus and scope of work. CSR can be incorporated into a corporates' essential decision making scientifically for maximum output. Today, most corporates already have guidelines for consumer management, community relations, employee's retention, and the environment. All these goals can be the perfect starting point to plan further and develop CSR activities.

Now we will discuss a basic outline of planning, developing and implementing CSR initiatives. This concept is based on a simple formula - plan, execute, evaluate and improve.

Below is a framework that has been designed with the idea to be flexible so that the corporates can edit it and adapt it as and when required.

Assessment

- Do a fundamental assessment of the corporate's current scenario and activities.
- Recognise and involve significant stakeholders.
- Find out the core values, motivations and level of engagement with stakeholders.
- Try to finalise a mission statement and the core resolution of an organisation.
- Gather a CSR management team.
- Develop a working definition of CSR particular to your brand, product, and intended outcome.
- Review the already existing corporate policies, processes and initiatives.

All the points mentioned above will give you a clear picture of where does your corporate stand. This would be your starting point and will determine future strategies for superior results.

Develop a strategy

- Set out the objectives as it will make planning more focused.
- Objectives can be derived from the vision and mission of the corporate.
- Create a support system by including senior management who can help in the decision-making process at later stages.
- Map the market and competition.
- Formulate a matrix of planned CSR actions.
- Develop concepts for proceeding and to support them produce business cases.
- Select the path, methodologies, and areas for attention.

Setting goals are not that easy, especially when it comes to large corporates. It is a huge task to set priorities because of multiple and sometimes conflicting needs of various stakeholders. Also, it is crucial to have strategies that are relevant socially and significant to the business.

Formulate commitment

- Examine the CSR commitments that you created during strategy making phase.
- Have multiple discussion sessions with key stakeholders.
- Place a working group that can help achieve the commitments.
- Create an initial draft of all the commitments with stakeholders.
- Go back to stakeholders and further discuss the initial draft to find gaps.

It is vital to talk to the stakeholders multiple times before you lock your commitment. Only the stakeholders can articulate what exactly they need and how can you help them.

13.5.2 Implementing

Implementation/Action

- Bring together all the CSR decision-making structures chalked out during the Planning stage.
- Prepare and implement a CSR business plan while keeping the commitments and goals in mind.
- The action plan should include multiple tasks that can bring the strategy to life.
- Set measurable targets so that you can access the performance in the end.
- Set timelines for all the targets. It helps to achieve them.
- Identify performance measures and tools to do it.
- Involve employees and other stakeholders by placing incentives.
- Plan and conduct training.
- Launch instruments for addressing challenging conduct.
- Craft communications plans for both internal and external publics

While implementing, make sure that there should be a balance between corporate culture and strategic commitment. All the stakeholders should be involved directly or indirectly. Setting measurable targets and timelines will help you in the future to assess the success of your actions.

13.5.3 Evaluating

Confirm and make a report

- Measure and confirm performance.
- Involve stakeholders for gauging the accurate picture.
- Make a performance report.

Evaluate and improve

- Assess performance on the pre-decided standards.
- Recognise gaps.
- Find out opportunities to improve.
- Include stakeholders

Reporting and Evaluating are the best tools to create transparency and accountability. It allows the CSR team to measure the performance of the implementing team and judge the overall performance. This includes the outcome of the whole CSR campaign.

Every plan needs some scrutinising and adjusting from time to time. CSR planning is no different, and evaluation gives way to improvement. Remember that stakeholders need to be involved in every CSR process to keep it streamlined and focused.

This is how one cycle is completed, and it gives birth to the next cycle. Each cycle gives evidence and support for better planning in the future. Always carry on the past evaluations in your future strategies to obtain optimum results.

Check Your Progress Exercise 4

Notes: 1) Use the space below for your answer.

2) Compare your answers with those given at the end of this Unit.

1) Choose any corporate and write about its CSR imitative (only one) with the following details:

- Name of the CSR activity with little detail about its
- Main stakeholders
- Objectives
- Outcomes

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13.6 CSR AND CORPORATE GOVERNANCE

Now that we know how to plan out and execute our CSR projects, it is time to know about the concept of Corporate Governance. In this section, let us define it, gauge its scope and benefits.

13.6.1 What is Corporate Governance?

As the term suggests, Corporate Governance (CG) is the way a corporate is governed. Governance itself implies that it is an act of managing a corporate. It is a vital technique to balance the interests of the stakeholders such as consumers, management, employees, financial institutions, government and last but not least, the general public.

Through CG, corporates try to reach an equilibrium point of economic and social benefits. It is a system of law and effective tactics by which corporates are directed and organised. CG is the set of guidelines, techniques, and directions governing the relationship among the Board of Directors (BOD), key shareholders, and

managers in a corporate setup. It is well-defined by the laws, the charter, the company's bylaws, and prescribed policies.

CG makes the corporate more accountable to its key stakeholders. It plays an essential role in protecting the rights of stakeholders like staff, stockholders, community, costumes etc., who can be affected by the company's work but do not play an active part in decision-making activities daily.

Corporate governance has developed around a few basic principles, which give ground for directions and guidelines. The following corporate governance principles have been devised to be relevant to all organisations covered by the CG Code:

Structure

Every corporate should have an active board. Role and responsibilities should be well-formed and laid down for everyone.

Board and Committees

The CG board should involve independent Directors with the right attitude towards the needs of stakeholders. The Board should be the right blend of executive and non-executive Directors, independent and non-independent Directors. This is to make sure that the Board's decisions would be free from any prejudice. The size and level of the range of Board should represent the size and complexity of the corporate. Further, Board Committees should be formed for the board's assistance and carry out their decisions effectively.

Appointments

All the processes, starting from the appointment of a Director of the Board, election, induction to re-election, should be fair and transparent. Board candidates should be selected only on merit. Talent, information, understanding, and impartiality should be given special attention while choosing the right candidates. Special attention should be given to diversity, including gender. A well-thought, well planned and transparent process must be in place for all key officeholders.

Responsibilities, Pay, and Performance

All the key office holders should be well-versed with their legal responsibilities. They should enforce high ethical and moral standards and promote appropriate work culture. No Director should be overburdened so that they have ample time to fulfil their responsibilities. There should be no conflict of interest, and if there is any, it should be sorted out beforehand. The Board and related committees should receive the full relevant information promptly to ensure better performance. Evaluation of Directors' and committees' performance should be done appropriately to ensure the quality of performance. This brings transparency and sets the ground to determine the compensation for Directors and committee executives.

Risk Management

The Board is responsible for risk governance and ensures that the corporate should have a solid and detailed plan for risk management. In Unit 13 of this Block, you have studied the basics and process of Crisis Management, and the same principles apply to managing a crisis or risk situation that might surface during any CSR

implementations. There can be a chance of a good thought going bad or a well thought out vision colliding with some government policies or community exceptions. A good PR strategy would be required to manage such crisis matters.

Honesty

The Board should be honest in presenting the corporate' fiscal, culture, societal and governance performance while taking out the annual report. Such reports would have access by all the publics related or associated with the Company, and they would have the right to truthful and untwisted facts and figures.

Audit

Both Board and management should support the internal audit team. The audit team should be treated with cooperation and respect for carrying out the assigned task. The appointment of an internal audit team should be fair, transparent and formal.

Stakeholders

The board's responsibility is to make sure that the corporate and stakeholders exchange dialogue from time to time. The Board should honour the interest of shareholders and management simultaneously while fulfilling the ultimate purpose.

Now that we understand the basics of Corporate Governance, let's see some of its benefits:

- Good CG can ensure wholesome corporate success with financial progress.
- CG helps maintain the investors' confidence in the corporate business model, leading to more capital for future investments.
- It decreases the capital cost.
- CG works as a motivational factor for managers and employees to achieve better results for all the stakeholders.
- It increases the value of the business in the share market.
- CG helps in reducing unethical practices, risks, and any misconduct.
- Intense CG brings brand recognition to the business.
- Last but not least, it ensures that the business is fair in managing every stakeholder's interest.

13.6.2 Interrelation between CSR and Corporate Governance

CSR and CG both aim at public and institutional aspects of the businesses. They inspire to provide a responsible, honest, ethically sound environment for everyone involved.

If we talk about the relationship between both practices, we find a lot of similarities. They seem different on many levels in terms of law and its practice, but both the terms are very closely related.

We understood how vital CG is for the smooth and corruption-free function of the corporate world. We also saw that CSR activities are a significant step towards dynamic governance. To sum it up, we can say that the corporate that practice

intense CG are also who are taking care of their social and environmental responsibilities seriously through CSR.

Nowadays, every Corporate wants to earn a good name as it helps in flourishing the business and is suitable for branding. To achieve this purpose, both CSR and CG have to work hand in hand. The Corporate has to be well governed from the inside and take care of its social accountability externally.

If a Corporate is not practising an intense CG, it is improbable to have a moral sense of responsibility towards the community. So the first thing to ensure a good CSR practice is an intense CG.

Gradually, CSR gets merged with CG as both of them work towards fair and morally strong business. Both are directed by some kind of law and guidelines provided by the government. However, Corporate are free to go beyond the rules to do further good deeds for the community.

CSR and CG motivate the ethical practices, and well-being of all the stakeholders involved, both directly or indirectly. Both practices help businesses in terms of image-building and branding. This could directly affect the bottom line and future of any business.

CSR is built on the idea of self-governance, which is a part of external rules and regulations. However, CG is a larger regulatory instrument within which a corporate take its organisational resolutions.

CG is more about better bottom-line and smooth functioning, whereas CSR gets its fund from profits from shareholders' pockets and goes to stakeholders.

Employees are a very vital part of both CSR and CG. CG ensures that the voice of employees reaches the management in a timely fashion and any unethical practices (exploitation of employees) discontinue from the business altogether. CSR initiatives keep employees involved in various activities so that they can be a part of the good deeds of the corporate. These practices boost the morale of the employee, keep them motivated and reduce the attrition rate too.

Lastly, to make an effective CSR plan, corporate have to make sure that they have sturdy CG policies, which can further ensure the CSR vision of the business.

Check Your Progress Exercise 5

Notes: 1) Use the space below for your answer.

2) Compare your answers with those given at the end of this Unit.

1) Define Corporate Governance

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2) Write two benefits of Corporate Governance.

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3) CSR and corporate governance are two sides of the same coin. (T/F)

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13.7 LET US SUM UP

In this Unit, we talked about how CSR is the buzzing word in today's corporate scenario. Almost all the corporate are including CSR initiatives in their timelines to obey the rules and reap its benefits. Numerous businesses are investing much more than the prescribed percentage into CSR to be looked at as an ethically sound business practice.

CSR has always been a part of businesses around the world, but it was never as streamlined and popular as it is nowadays. CSR builds trust, increases the brand value and boosts the sale all at the same time. It is also looked at like a great PR activity as it makes room for a corporate in media without additional cost. A worthy CSR initiative pulls all the required media coverage. That's why CSR is among the favourite tools for PR these days.

Despite any direct connection, CSR treats almost everyone as a stakeholder and tries to improve the social standard. Sometimes by initiating programs related to education, health or environment and other times by extending donations to NGOs working on the chosen cause.

CSR is an ongoing cycle. One ends, and the next starts. And every cycle gives a foundation for the next one to build on. It involves all the steps of a campaign, from research to execution. And like any other campaign, CSR initiatives need proper planning and a dedicated team to execute them.

Corporate Governance and CSR go hand in hand to make sure that the corporate works as an ethical and moral business, ensuring all the stakeholders' well-being and not just for profit.

13.8 REFERENCES AND FURTHER READINGS

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13.9 ANSWER TO CHECK YOUR PROGRESS EXERCISES

Check Your Progress Exercise 1

1. CSR is a way for corporates works towards holistic development (True)
2. In 2013, an amendment was made in the Company Act, Section 135, to make CSR compulsory for corporates.
3. How much a corporate has to spend on CSR as per company law? At least two per cent.
4. Corporates having a net value of Rs 5 billion or more, companies with a turnover of Rs 10 billion or more or having a net profit of Rs 50 million and above during any single financial year come under this Act.

Check Your Progress Exercise 2

1. Define the period between 1968-73 concerning CSR. This period is known as 'issue'. Here businesses started recognizing issues they want to work with. Issues like discrimination, climate change, poverty gained significant attention. Many researchers believe that CSR as we know it now started taking shape in the 1950s.
2. Who is referred to as the father of CSR?

Check Your Progress Exercise 3

1. Development is the responsibility of the government and not the corporate. (False)
2. CSR initiatives for benefits like better sales, valuable brand and loyal consumers. (True)
3. Good CSR is the key to better government relations/government PR. (True)

Check Your Progress Exercise 4

1. Choose any corporate and write about its CSR initiative. Here, you can discuss any CSR activity that has caught your attention in the recent past. Try to evaluate it based on the knowledge you have gained in this Unit. You can pick a famous Company or a thriving business in your vicinity.

Check Your Progress Exercise 5

1. Define Corporate Governance Corporate Governance (CG) is the way a corporate is governed. Governance itself suggests that it is an act of managing a corporate. It is a vital technique to balance stakeholders' interests such as consumers, management, employees, financial institutions, government, and the general public.
2. Write two benefits of Corporate Governance.
 - CG helps in reducing unethical practices, risks, and any misconduct.
 - Good CG can ensure wholesome corporate success with financial progress
3. CSR and corporate governance are two sides of the same coin. (True)